YOUR HOPE IS NOT LOST

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Full edition

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FOREWORD.

We are living in a season or at a time of many uncertainties. Sometimes, we are not even sure about the afternoon but on the same day. Anything can happen at any time. In some cases, employment is replaced suddenly by unemployment, health replaced by disease and sickness, peace by violence, disorder and war; life replaced instantly by death.
But amidst these chaos, over this world, there is still hope- as we look to Jesus over the work he personally did for you and me. In other words, the salvation and blessings he brought to us. This is exactly the way of the time of Moses when that rebellious generation was bitten by fiery serpents. Although that was as a result of the rebellion of Israel but within that pain and fear, GOD told Moses to make a fiery serpent. By the mercy of GOD, those who could look at it would still live and not die. So Moses made that bronze serpent.

[7] Therefore the people came to Moses, and said, "We have sinned, for we have spoken against the LORD and against you; pray to the LORD that He take away the serpents from us." So Moses prayed for the people. [8] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Make a fiery serpent, and set it on a pole; and it shall be that everyone who is bitten, when he looks at it, shall live." [9] So Moses made a bronze serpent, and put it on a pole; and so it was, if a serpent had bitten anyone, when he looked at the bronze serpent, he lived.
Numbers 21:7-9 NKJV

JESUS referred to this event in the book of John, by saying:
"And as Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, even so must the Son of Man be lifted up, [15] "that whoever believes in Him should not perish but have eternal life.
John 3:14-15 NKJV

My old schoolmate commented on that account before I finally published this book. Below is what she wrote:

In the Old testament, it is all about Jesus concealed and in the New testament, it is Jesus revealed.

Luke 24:27

So what happened in the wilderness in Numbers 21 :8-9 was an illustration/ shadow (typology) of what was to be fulfilled by Christ ..
By looking at the bronze serpent they were healed...
Presently through the death, burial and the resurrection of Christ, those who believe are saved. Christ is the hope of our glory and in Him consist all things...We continue Looking up to Him ,the Author and Finisher of Our Faith…Hallelujah.

I really liked the comment. Its truth is inspiring, undeniable and encouraging.

So, it is a reality that we are passing through uncertainties and the pain of the bite of the Enemy. But on the other hand, we still have hope and live even into eternal life through Jesus Christ. *We should still look to him for help not over our pain, rejection, sicknesses, fears and the challenges of this life.* He has the solution to what is happening in the world today and what we may face tomorrow. This message is intended to bring hope to those passing through the storms of this life and the fears of tomorrow. As Bartimaeus found his healing, restoration and destiny in the Lord, you too can find the same. You do not have to be stressed or take your own life- *there is still hope through the Lord Jesus.*
Therefore, this message has taken much consideration over one man in the Bible, who turned to Jesus and had seen his eyes opened- *Bartimaeus - the son of Timaeus.*

He looked to Jesus and had his pain gone. Will you look to Jesus today? His hands are still open and waiting for you. He wants you to turn from the noise of this world, the pain of that fiery serpent's bite and the fears of the storms passing on Earth today. *You should look to him who is the Author and Finisher of our faith.* The Healer, the Resurrection and the Life; the Prince of peace, the Way, the Truth…and the Savior of the world.
So, the issue is not about how big is the storm but how big is the Prince of Peace or how powerful is Jesus. There is still hope even in the middle of a storm. A person who is with Jesus, in the middle of a storm, has more hope than that one over calm waters but without Jesus. That storm will turn into peace but those calm waters into a horrible storm then into both physical and spiritual death. That is a disaster.
This book is intended to encourage you that Jesus is alive and your hope is not lost. Just as Bartimaeus' hope was not lost after suffering for years, you too can find that hope through the same Jesus of Nazareth.
In this encounter between Bartimaeus and the *Lord Jesus*, I would like you to note and learn the following:

(1). It was a normal or an ordinary day in the physical.
(2). Bartimaeus heard and was convinced that the Man was Jesus.
(3). Bartimaeus threw aside his garment.
(4). The spot was necessary for that encounter and great miracle.
(5). The day started with blindness but ended with clear sight.
(6). He could have lost that great miracle if he listened to those stopping him.
(7). The faith of Bartimaeus.
(8). After that great miracle, he followed the Lord on the road.
Finally, there is still hope that you can live again.

Through the journey of this book you will also get connected to other series including:
Your Hope Is Not Lost (a full edition), *The Great Story of Boldness and Courage*, *Fear Not*, *Who Is To Blame...and more.*

THE AUTHOR.

I was born from a Muslim mother but my father was a Catholic and a government agent (CID), in Malawi. I grew up in the Church of England but later started a full- time ministry. My journey of writing Christian literature started within some circumstances which I described in the other upcoming book- *THE GREAT STORY OF BOLDNESS AND COURAGE.*
I Hope you will be encouraged after reading this book which is part of the series- *FINDING JESUS TODAY.*

JESUS IS ALIVE AND YOUR HOPE IS NOT LOST.

You are going to enjoy it.

Thank you.

Enock Mbendera.

FINDING JESUS TODAY SERIES.

YOUR HOPE IS NOT LOST.

THE STORY OF BARTIMAEUS- THE SON OF TIMAEUS.

I. LIFE LESSONS- PART I.

Bible Passage.

46 Now they came to Jericho. As He went out of Jericho with His disciples and a great multitude, blind Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, sat by the road begging. 47 And when he heard that it was Jesus of Nazareth, he began to cry out and say, "Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me!" 48 Then many warned him to be quiet; but he cried out all the more, "Son of David, have mercy on me!" 49 So Jesus stood still and commanded him to be called. Then they called the blind man, saying to him, "Be of good cheer. Rise, He is calling you." 50 And throwing aside his garment, he rose and came to Jesus. 51 So Jesus answered and said to him, "What do you want Me to do for you?" The blind man said to Him, "Rabboni, that I may receive my sight." 52 Then Jesus said to him, "Go your way; your faith has made you well." And immediately he received his sight and followed Jesus on the road.

(Mark 10:46-52|NKJV].

Bartimaeus was a blind man and spent most of his time begging in Jericho.
There are a number of beautiful and deep lessons that we can learn and help us in our Christian walk.
But first, let's look at the city of Jericho.
The old Jericho was destroyed by Joshua and he declared a curse over a person who would rebuild it.
Then Joshua charged them at that time, saying, "Cursed be the man before the LORD who rises up and builds this city Jericho; he shall lay its foundation with his firstborn, and with his youngest he shall set up its gates."
Joshua 6:26 NKJV

Traditionally, this is the old Jericho or the ancient site known as Tel es- Sultan. It was a Canaanite city and about two kilometers north of the modern Jericho.
The second city of Jericho was during the time of the Lord Jesus and about the time of the Second Temple. It was notably built by Herod the Great but not on the same old site. It had moved slightly to a new position and near the present city.
The second one was the city of Jericho where Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, met the Lord. It was also the same city where he met Zacchaeus (***Luke 19***). It had a large Jewish population but also an important and prosperous city.
The modern Jericho is a Palestinian city and near the ancient ruins.

Back to Life Lessons- part 1.

THE DAY LOOKED ORDINARY.

When his day had finally come, things looked normal. It was about getting someone guide him to the right spot; sitting and begging under harsh or beautiful weather conditions. *It looked like an ordinary day in the physical.* Indeed, nothing showed that it was one of his greatest days on Earth.
IN THE SPIRITUAL REALM, THINGS WERE DIFFERENT. HIS GREAT DAY HAD COME.

You can see the battle and efforts applied to make practical what was in the spiritual realm.
It was not that easy for this blind man, Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus.
This is what is happening in our Christian walk today. We must be careful how we handle the days we pass through. Some days are not ordinary. They are carefully and specially intended for Heaven to remember us. Some have already missed their great days because of the mood, place and actions they took on that great day. Be careful not to be carnally minded in your daily life. Be a spiritually minded person always. Again, there are special days intended for Heaven to remember us. Do not let evil thoughts, anger, resentment, grudges, bad mood and temper make you miss your day.
Some even praise themselves by saying: "I am in a bad mood today, my temper is high, do not provoke me today…" But they never know what is behind that particular day. It can be one of their best days in life; the day that their long- awaited husband is coming.

This was the day of the son of Timaeus.
It did not find him seeing or with sight but still blind, not at home but by the roadside, not giving money to people but begging from them, not in Jerusalem but in Jericho. You should be careful how you handle your days. It can come when you are broke, when you have received the worst insults. When you have received false allegations and rejection in one pack; as though an item and a bonus. But they are all toxic or spiritual poison. In short, Vernon from the Enemy.
You do not know the day that the Lord can change your history and for good.
Bartimaeus used his day wisely and received his great miracle.

He heard that the person who was passing was Jesus of Nazareth.

How did he prove it to be true?
In this case, it was his responsibility to find out or search; to verify or prove, though blind, *that the man passing along was really the Savior of the world. He had the responsibility to prove that the man was really that great healer from Nazareth.*
I believe that the way people moved, what he heard, and his own conviction made him to be confident about this fact. He was sure that the Man who was passing along was Jesus of Nazareth.
It was the responsibility of the people to tell him that he was Jesus since he was blind. On the other hand, it was his duty to prove that the saying was true and take the necessary action.

In other words, it is the responsibility of the pastor to preach to you about Jesus Christ. But it is also your responsibility, *to prove the same by the scriptures.*
Brothers and sisters, we are not at the climax of apostasy by the time of writing this book. *It is our responsibility to prove about Jesus Christ.* If we cannot do this now, will we be able to prove about him at that critical time of the great apostasy? We should prove whether he is the real Jesus Christ; that *Jesus of Nazareth.* There is only one Man with that title. But there can also be "Jesus" as a general name. The sons of Sceva were challenged by an evil spirit about which Jesus they served. The spirit also knew apostle Paul as a true servant of the Lord and worthy of using his authority.

[***13] Then some of the itinerant Jewish exorcists took it upon themselves to call the name of the Lord Jesus over those who had evil spirits, saying, "We exorcise you by the Jesus whom Paul preaches." [14] Also there were seven sons of Sceva, a Jewish chief priest, who did so. [15] And the evil spirit answered and said, "Jesus I know, and Paul I know; but who are you?" [16] Then the man in whom the evil spirit was leaped on them, overpowered them, and prevailed against them, so that they fled out of that house naked and wounded. [17] This became known both to all Jews and Greeks dwelling in Ephesus; and fear fell on them all, and the name of the Lord Jesus was magnified.***
Acts 19:13-17 NKJV

So the scene ended in a disaster for the sons of Sceva. *They had no personal relationship with Jesus and had no authority delegated to them after his resurrection.*
Many false prophets are coming into this world and are going to arise. If we do not master the truth and wisdom that guide us towards the true Christ, teachers, prophets, and apostles, we will have no one to blame. *The Holy Spirit is always there to help us.*
If we miss this part, I am so sure that many are going to be overwhelmed by many false christs. They may fall into the trap of the Antichrist and miss the real *miracle worker and the Savior of the world- Jesus of Nazareth.*
It takes a great deal of knowing the scriptures and meditating on the same to prove, confirm, and find the real Christ.
I have heard a lot of people complain about false prophets and leaving out false teachers and false apostles as the Bible warns about all of them. But I have also observed that the problem is not the false prophets, false teachers or the false apostles only.
The problem may also be with ourselves. *We have not mastered the biblical wisdom of finding the real and true Jesus of Nazareth. If we are not careful, many are going to fall into the trap I have mentioned above.*
The right time to position ourselves and familiarize with the true Christ is now, this day, this week, this month, this year and these end times. Things are changing and will continue to change. Others are going to change even faster. *We should master the Biblical wisdom of knowing the true Christ for the Antichrist is about to appear on Earth. Many false christs are already there. The Antichrist will make life difficult for believers of the true Christ.*
Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, made an effort to find and prove the real and true Jesus of Nazareth. He proved him before finding his real, true, genuine and lifetime miracle; before the opening of his blind eyes.
I will prove to you, in the other part to follow, that he really mastered him. On the day they met, it was just about implementing what he had heard and known about Jesus.

II. LIFE LESSONS- PART II.

No matter how complicated your situation is, your hope is not lost. If you meet Jesus, something new will happen.
In the first part of the story of Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, we discussed two important things about his encounter with Jesus. Firstly, we noted that it was a normal or ordinary day in the physical. It was about someone guiding him, sitting by the roadside, and begging under harsh or beautiful weather conditions. It was normal business. *But in the spiritual realm, his great day had come. He had an appointment with Jesus of Nazareth who changed his story forever.* So we should be careful how we handle our days. We should avoid grudges, resentments, anger, hatred etc. GOD can use a single day to change a person's story forever.
Secondly, he heard and verified that the Man who was passing was *Jesus of Nazareth*. I said that I would prove to you that he mastered Jesus before they met on that particular

day. So the issue of Jesus did not just come up on the same day. It was in his heart, running through his mind, flowing in his blood and when they met, he just blew up what was built up inside him. He released what he had kept, in his heart, *about the greatest healer from Nazareth.* That was why no one could stop him. He got his miracle. It was impossible for him to miss his miracle. That day was like a wrapper with a great gift of sight inside. It was a special gift from Heaven to him.

THE PROOF OF THE POINT ABOVE.

The title he used- ***SON OF DAVID*** and the statement: "***RABBONI, THAT I MAY RECEIVE MY SIGHT.***"
To know Jesus as son of David shows that he knew the genealogy but also, the Theology of JESUS. This was not a Jewish teacher, not a Pharisee, Sadducee or a Scribe but a blind man. He had never met Jesus before but new and believed in him in advance. Secondly, the other title that he used, Rabboni, for teacher shows that he was aware of a great teacher living in Israel. On top of that, the fact that he said that he wanted his sight, shows that he knew in advance that there was a great healer in Israel who could give him his sight. So it was already in him and when they met, it just blew up through his unstoppable faith from that foundation. That was why no one could stop him and he received his great miracle. He received his sight. Sometimes, being stubborn in believing GOD, in prayer, in holiness and in pursuit of the will of GOD is so good. It will pay off in this life and that to come. But stubbornness in committing sin or following Satan is a great disaster. Bartimaeus stood for his faith to meet Jesus and it paid off greatly. He was persistent in his faith amidst opposition. Some have drawn back from following the Lord by a small opposition; not this man of Jericho. Will you do the same?

THE MAIN LIFE LESSON.

Today, many people want to meet Jesus when their hearts and faith are not fully prepared. They go to Church without their hearts prepared to attend a church service. It is as though they are forced to attend a church service. They go to church with their body but their hearts are far away from that church gathering; far from the preacher and far from the sermon.
If they were to be asked, by surprise, what they wanted, some would stammer. They are not in the hymn; their hearts are singing another song altogether. They are not in the prayer. Their mind is far away somewhere contrary to where they are physically. They are not ready or they are not prepared. They go to church like by trial and error. *It can happen or not. It can happen in the physical but may not spiritually or in their hearts.* They are not in the offering. They can give or not. They can give the full amount from their purse or give halfway down and even the quarter of it. They can give far down or on the far side of that purse. The hand searching for the lowest amount as an offering to GOD who gives them life. Some even doze but cannot slumber when watching a football match. When others say “Amen," they sometimes miss it. That is why although ***Jesus is the same yesterday, today and forever*** but some people go to church and come back the same.

People go into a bottle or liquor store and come back changed but for evil. The joy, the singing and the boldness will not live long for they are earthly and temporary. They go to a football match and come back changed.
Their team has won a trophy and they are joyful but when another team takes that trophy, that joy has gone. But you see them coming back celebrating or *changed*.
Jesus paid a high price for his Church with his own precious blood. Therefore, people are supposed to go to the church of the Lord and come back completely changed and for his glory.
Isn't that beautiful and Good News? You are supposed to go wounded and come back healed. If you go with the sorrows of this world, you are supposed to come back with his joy. Learn to go there prepared and well positioned. *There is nothing impossible with GOD.*
Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, got a great breakthrough or a great miracle because the encounter was already settled in him. He knew Christ well and built up his faith on that knowledge then released what was already built up in him.
That was why he never allowed anyone to rob his day. No one was allowed to tamper with his faith on Jesus and stop his great miracle. He put a protective hedge around it. His heart was with and for Jesus before they met. You should protect your faith; don't allow anyone or anything weaken your faith in Jesus. Everyone has his or her own day of death and grave. The only exemption is for those who will go into a shared or mass grave and others who will be taken to Heaven alive. *It will happen in a twinkle of an eye and having their bodies transformed.*
So, do not allow anyone or anything stop or weaken your faith in Jesus. The world is coming to an end. He is coming to take the saints and you should be one of them.
Therefore, guard your faith jealously and strongly. Bartimaeus prevailed because he guarded his faith against those opposing him. There is great opposition against your faith in Jesus out there. You should stand boldly for your faith now.

As far as Jesus is alive, your hope is not lost.
You should get ready to meet him and never miss your miracle.
Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, never missed his day and his great miracle.

YOUR HOPE IS NOT LOST.

May GOD bless you exceedingly.
Amen.
THE STORY OF BARTIMAEUS- The Son Of Timaeus.

III. LIFE LESSONS- PART III.

HE THREW ASIDE HIS GARMENT.

No matter how complicated or complex your situation may be, your hope is not lost.
If you meet Jesus, something new will happen.
In the second part, I indicated that Bartimaeus heard and verified that the Man who was passing was Jesus of Nazareth. The way he addresses Jesus reveals this fact. So the issue of Jesus did not just come up on the day they met.
It was in his heart, running in his mind, flowing through his blood and when they met, he just blew up what was already in him.
Again, Jesus is the same yesterday, today and forever. It is the people's faith that has changed.

Part 111.

50] And throwing aside his garment, he rose and came to Jesus. [51] So Jesus answered and said to him, "What do you want Me to do for you?" The blind man said to Him, "Rabboni, that I may receive my sight." [52] Then Jesus said to him, "Go your way; your faith has made you well." And immediately he received his sight and followed Jesus on the road.
Mark 10:50-52

Today's life Lesson is from verse 50 of Mark 10.

HE THREW ASIDE HIS GARMENT.

WHY THROW ASIDE HIS GARMENT BEFORE MEETING JESUS?

In this topic, I will talk about the traditions that have caused some Christians to miss the supernatural acts and their breakthroughs. Some traditions have a louder voice than that of the Holy Spirit, making people miss the will of GOD. The voice of the Holy Spirit should be above every tradition.

Some of these traditions are;

Kneeling but with a proud heart.

The tradition of fasting but not led or influenced by the Holy Spirit. Do not forget that the Holy Spirit drew the Lord Jesus into the wilderness where he fasted for forty days. Jesus did not go there and fast traditionally. He was led by the Holy Spirit.

Making the symbol of the cross in the name of the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit.

When Amen is used traditionally.
When tongues are spoken traditionally.
Some prayers are not answered because we pray according to a particular tradition instead of being led by the Holy Spirit. In other words, we do not value praying in the spirit and truth(John 4:23) but according to some tradition.

Bartimaeus Throws Aside His Garment.

I thought meeting Jesus had to do with presenting yourself well or well dressed before him? We dress decent when going to church, offices, weddings, when meeting executive persons and even when attempting interviews .
.
Before I go further, I would like you to take note of the following fact.
The Bible says that Bartimaeus threw *aside* his garment and not *away*. What is the difference between throwing aside and throwing away?

To throw aside means ignore, temporarily reject, abandon, or set something aside, often with disdain.
It suggests pushing something out of your way but not necessarily into the trash whilst
To throw away means to get rid of, discard, or put something in the trash because it is no longer wanted, useful, or broken.
You should, therefore, note that some things are good but not necessary at a certain point, time, circumstances and place.
Bartimaeus put aside his garment when he wanted to meet the Lord. But why did he put his garment aside? This is the only case recorded in the Bible where a person puts aside his garment before meeting the Lord. Some actions are not ordinary.

Garments In Ancient Israel And The Second Temple Period.

Tunics.
It was for both men and women. It was mostly made of wool or linen.
Gen. 37: 3.

Mantles/ Outer Robes.
A heavier garment but cloak- like and worn on top or over the tunic. This was for warmth or modesty.
Ex 22: 25

Belts/ Sashes (Avnet)
As in modern days (with belts), they were used to tie tunics at the waist.

*Head Coverin*g.
Men would cover their heads with a cloth or turban- like wrap, especially in the harsh sun.

Special Garments.

Tzitzit.
Fringes over the corners of a four- cornered garment.
It was commanded in Numbers 15: 38- 39.

Priests(*Kohanim*).
They wore special garments as described in Ex. 28: 2- 4.

Some of them are:
The ephod, breastplate (*Choshen*) and the miter (*Mitznefet or Mitsnepheth*) for the High Priest.

Footwear.
Sandals were often made from leather.
Deut. 25.9

Meaning and Symbolism.

Modesty and Identity.
It was for modesty but also, represented an individual's standing, occupation and role in society.

Some styles and colors marked social status and marked the difference between Israel and other people.

Commandments.

Some garments were based on commandments from the Torah. The New Testament has some instructions on clothing as well, especially inside and outside the churches of the saints.
Therefore, the Old Testament has different commandments about garments including wearing of the tzitzit; related to four- cornered garments.

Combination of wool and linen in one garment was forbidden (*shaatnez or shatnes*).
Lev 19: 19, Deut. 22:11.

Tearing Clothes.
It was a symbol of mourning or distress.
2 Sam. 1:11

Garments also expressed honor, ritual purity and shame.

This can also be learned from Joseph's special coat of many colors, the garments of the High Priest or the sackcloth in repentance.

Temple service.
The priestly garments were a signal of holiness or purity and service to GOD.
But the (eight) garments of the High Priest were for glory and beauty as described in Ex 28:2.

The eight garments of the High Priest:

Breastplate (*Choshen*).
Ex 28:15-28
It was warn over the heart with 12 stones representing the 12 tribes of Israel.

The Ephod.
Apron-like garment.
Ex 28:6

Robe Of The Ephod (*Me'il*).
Ex 28:31- 34
A blue in color with golden bells and pomegranates on the hem.

Tunic (*Ketonet*).
A checkered- pattern linen garment.

Turban(*Mitznefet*).
Ex 28:36-37
A head covering.

Sash(*Avnet*).
A belt.

Front plate (*Tzitz*).
A golden crown engraved with "holiness to the Lord."

Note the difference between *Tzitzit* and *Tzitz*:

Tzitzit are specifically notted ritual fringes or tassels attached to the four corners of (*observant*) Jewish garments.
Tzitz refers especially to the priestly head plate or frontlet.

Trousers(*Miknasayim*).
Linen breeches.

On the Day of Atonement, the High Priest wore a separate set of four white linen garments instead of the golden ones.

These were the eight garments of a high priest as opposed to four garments (*tunic, trousers, turban and sash) for the ordinary priest*.

The garments of the High Priest were made of gold, blue, purple, scarlet and fine linen.
They were for glory and beauty.

For more references read:

Exodus 28 (*holy garments of the High Priest).*

Ex 39 (*the actual crafting and compilation of these garments*).

Lev 8 (*the priestly garments placed on Aaron and his sons during the consecration ceremony)*.

Ex 29 (*the garments in the context of inauguration of the priests*).

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garments.

Let's Move From Old Jericho To The Modern World.

How Modern Pastors Dress.
If you look at today's pastors or ministers, you will note that they look smart or dress decently. It's not like the Reverends we had in the 70s. I grew up in a predominantly Muslim and an Anglican missionary field. I still remember an Anglican clergy then, using a humber bicycle and he did not care about high life. He seemed to be satisfied with his way of life. You should not focus on the year but the character lest you say it was an old fashioned world or culture. But I am pointing towards the heart versus the current lifestyle in reference to Bartimaeus- the son of Timaeus. *He Threw Aside His Garment.*

I am of the Generation X but for the sake of the Millennial Generation or Generation Y, the Generation Z or iGen; Generation Alpha, the Generation Beta and others to come,

here is a short description of a Humber bicycle. It was invented by Thomas Humber in the 19th Century.
It was popular in our time before other types came along and many of them smaller and faster.
So, this Anglican clergy used this type of bicycle. Others did not own any bicycle at all; they used to walk on foot. But they loved their work and led a humble life. This is not an age or periodic fact. We had many priests or pastors who led a simple life and they were satisfied with that lifestyle. They had their kids sent to school and others became highly educated but from that humble background. GOD still blessed them in different ways.
In the modern world, it is rare to have pastors who do not care about status. A humber bicycle in 2026? The reason is not about time but likely, the love a decent lifestyle. This will not leave out decent dressing and the way of travel.

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

The majority of the modern- world pastors would not ride this strong bicycle. Again, not because we are in the 21st Century (at the time of writing this book) but that they like decent things including dressing and food too. So, it's not necessarily a periodic issue. They like decent things.
I remember some years ago, around ten years by now, I went back home. It is a predominantly Muslim community. It has some Christians from the Anglican society. They came along with the U.M.C.A missionaries from the north and settled in our area. We have that community too.
In short, a woman *(*a widow and a Born- Again Christian from the church of England) asked me to pray for her grandson. I did not go there right away. I wanted to find *the right time in my spirit* and go for the prayers. The right day came and I asked a leader of a fellowship, in my area, to accompany me. He is from the Church of England too and a cook at their institution- *St. Michael's Girls Secondary School.* He owned a type of a humber bicycle though I didn't read anywhere. But looking at that old and strong model, I knew it was likely a humber type. He carried me to that area along the shores of Lake Malawi- *the Lake of Stars.*

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

There were a number of families with gardens and close to a thick field of reeds. I sat leaning on the small shelter she owned. But just opposite to where I sat, inside that shelter, there was a cobra type of snake. They were staying together without knowing it.
Instead of praying for the child only, I felt to pray for the woman as well. When I put my hands on her, I felt the power of the Lord over her but not on the grandson.
We left by the same old- model bicycle. On the following day, she encountered that cobra right in her shelter. The neighbors were not there. She took a burning wood from a fire place and a panga. The battle began and the snake managed to spit over her face but it did not affect her. The fight continued until the snake was defeated. Her family was saved from the deadly bite of that snake. It was by the grace of the Lord. But we travelled by that old – model bicycle, this 21st Century.

It was not one of the modern cars, SUVs, Trucks, Vans, Hybrids or Electronic...but it was an old- model bicycle. The prayer session worked well but we used an old bicycle. A Christian widow and her family were saved from that cobra. It was not a physical battle only; it was a spiritual battle too. It needed some prayers.
The full story is in the upcoming book- *The Great Story Of Boldness And Courage.*

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

Modern pastors like decent dressing and this applies even to their way of travel. Bartimaeus wanted to meet the Lord with a new school of thought. Why?

Let's Go Back To Jericho.

Why did Bartimaeus throw aside his garment? Did he not like to be well dressed or look decent before the Lord as we do in these days? *What was his school of thought or faith? Remember the priests had their way of dressing in those days when serving in the Temple. The High Priest had to put on eight garments and an ordinary priest had to put on four garments*
In my opinion, I would say the garment of Bartimaeus was necessary before the Lord.
Again, what was his school of thought and faith? Is it different from other ministers in this modern world?
Why throw aside his garment?
I see a great shift from how things were done in the Old Testament and the patterns of the New Testament. This Testament which is about the Kingdom of GOD and entering the same through the Only Way; *Jesus of Nazareth.*
The patterns and the approaches have started shifting. I see this in Jericho.; *that Jericho of the Second Temple period. I see this from the story of Bartimaeus- the son of Timaeus.*
I would like to remind you that Jesus is the greatest king. He is greater than Solomon and greater than Jonah. He is greater than the Temple and lord of the Sabbath. David, in his prophetic vision addressed him as Lord. The greatest man or prophet born of a woman, *John the Baptist*, was not worthy to loose his sandal strap (**John 1:27**). Jesus was far greater than him.

What manner of man was he?

John 1:14-18, 23- 27 NKJV

[14] And the Word became flesh and dwelt among us, and we beheld His glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father, full of grace and truth. [15] John bore witness of Him and cried out, saying, "This was He of whom I said, 'He who comes after me is preferred before me, for He was before me.' " [16] And of His fullness we have all received, and grace for grace. [17] For the law was given through Moses, but grace and truth came through Jesus Christ. [18] No one has seen God at any time. The only begotten Son, who is in the bosom of the Father, He has declared Him.

[23] He said: "I am 'The voice of one crying in the wilderness: "Make straight the way of the LORD," ' as the prophet Isaiah said." [24] Now those who were sent were from the Pharisees. [25] And they asked him, saying, "Why then do you baptize if you are not the Christ, nor Elijah, nor the Prophet?" [26] John answered them, saying, "I baptize with water, but there stands One among you whom you do not know. [27] "It is He who, coming after me, is preferred before me, whose sandal strap I am not worthy to loose."

Bartimaeus wanted to meet that great man and a universal figure. Why throw aside his garment?

Jesus had exceptional titles, authority, power, knowledge etc.
But he was so humble and one of his notable identities was humility. He never forced himself on anyone though he was powerful. He never invaded any human kingdom on earth yet having great and supernatural power. He only invaded the kingdom of the *dragon*, that *serpent of old*, who is the *Devil* and *Satan* (description according to **Rev 20:2**).
He fought his battle again Satan and his kingdom only. He was so humble.
He was and still, gracious, merciful and so loving. He is open and ready to accept anyone calling upon him. He loves sinners and even the worst sinner.
Bartimaeus wanted to meet such great figure. *Why did he throw aside his garment before meeting him?* Again, what was his school of thought and faith?
Although there can be many meanings symbolically but I chose the symbol of "*tradition*."

(As indicated at the beginning, you are going to find a list of some of these traditions below).

The garment of Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, symbolically represents tradition .

The tradition that can disturb you on your way to the Lord. This tradition that can hinder you from receiving your healing, blessing, breakthrough or your answers from the Lord.
It demands much attention from you and diverting or taking away that attention you have towards GOD. You should check out that tradition.
The tradition that has become a barrier between you and the Messiah. It disturbs and makes you busy along your way to meet the Savior. That is the garment that Bartimaeus throws aside.

Have I said tradition? Yes.
Although other writers or preachers may translate this into other schools of thought but my pick is the tradition.

By the way, do you know or remember the battle between Israel under king Saul and the Philistines under Goliath? (1 Sam 17).
Just to cut this account short. Saul put on his *traditional* amour on David. But David put it off saying that he could not use it and chose five smooth stones from a brook; one of

which brought the giant down. Before getting that victory, he first dealt away with the tradition of that military attire of king Saul.

[38] So Saul clothed David with his armor, and he put a bronze helmet on his head; he also clothed him with a coat of mail. [39] David fastened his sword to his armor and tried to walk, for he had not tested them. And David said to Saul, "I cannot walk with these, for I have not tested them." So David took them off. [40] Then he took his staff in his hand; and he chose for himself five smooth stones from the brook, and put them in a shepherd's bag, in a pouch which he had, and his sling was in his hand. And he drew near to the Philistine.
1 Samuel 17:38-40 NKJV

How can you face a heavily armored commander with such simple weapons? *David put away the tradition, as though throwing aside the garment and chose the supernatural. Some victories will not come until you put aside (or throw aside) some traditions and put on the supernatural through faith. The victory of the battle of the valley of Elah waited for a brave young man called David. He replaced the military tradition with the supernatural through his strong faith in GOD. He put aside an armor and chose five smooth stones from a brook (with a sling) and the giant was defeated.*

The tradition.
David chose to do away with the tradition of king Saul and went for the supernatural. He was putting aside the armor of the king not that of his brother Eliab. He was putting aside the tradition of the king and the commander of the army.
David got a great victory for himself and the entire nation. He ended that disgrace and shame that Goliath brought on king Saul and Israel.

Christians should check some traditions hindering their glory.
We wake up in the morning, a little prayer, brush the teeth, go into the shower, dress up, get breakfast, on our way to work; work through the files, have tea at the office then lunch break and nock off around 5.00pm. When we are back home, we watch television or on WhatsApp while waiting for supper. After supper then a little prayer and to bed.
This journey can take for many years while waiting for pension. Sometimes, we feel so comfortable with such a way or tradition. We forget to seek the Lord for five smooth stones from the brook and that sling.

One of the reasons why the Pharisees, Sadducees and the Scribes missed Jesus and his great power was the issue of tradition.
One of the reasons some people are missing their breakthroughs is the same tradition.

Bartimaeus threw aside his garment. He did not throw it away as through despising the days of his small beginnings. Those days when he was blind and others provided for him even that garment. The Bible says that he threw it aside. It should not disturb him on his way to meet the Master. The garment did not matter to him but the Lord and then, his healing.

Again, throwing aside is slightly different from throwing away. But we can see an act of faith towards his move or school of thought.
A brand- new garment and based on his desire, not someone's choice, was on the way. Why should this one make him busy on his way to Jesus?

These Traditions.

There are many traditions hindering Muslims, Buddhists, the Shinto, Rastafarians, Politicians and World Leaders, Footballers, Radio Announcers, Musicians, Lecturers, Lawyers, Human Rights Activists or Defenders and others from meeting Jesus. But he is readily available to the sinner.
He came to heal the sick and give comfort to the destitute or those marginalized.
He came for this great and unique service. He came with the grace of GOD for you and me.
So, this garment was someone's choice. The one of his best choice was awaiting after meeting Jesus. Why should the present one delay or disturb him?
Think about throwing it aside? We can see a great act of faith that he would receive sight and have total authority over his own choice?

He threw aside his garment representing tradition, the norm, the culture, the protocol. He wanted the supernatural way; the five smooth stones from the brook and the sling. His Goliath had to fall. But before that, the old garment had to be thrown aside like Saul's military attire from David.

What Is Your Tradition?
(Part of the list is written below)*.*

The Story Of Bartimaeus- the son of Timaeus.
So, from verse 49, when the Master gave him permission*,* the first thing he did was to throw aside his garment. There must be some traditions that we have to throw aside if we want to meet the Messiah for a breakthrough.
There should not be anything that will disturb or even hinder us on our way.

The Tradition.

In Mark 7:9-13, the Lord Jesus accused the religious leaders of rejecting the commandments of GOD that they may keep their tradition. In that way, they made the word of GOD of no effect because of their tradition.
The Story Of Bartimaeus- The Son Of Timaeus.
Bartimaeus is giving us a lesson to put aside certain norms, traditions, cultures, beliefs or the worldly protocols that can disturb or hinder the glory or the finger of God in our lives.
Bartimaeus had to throw aside one of his own in order to fit in to the new or the supernatural one from the Master. He did not want anyone or anything to disturb or delay his long- awaited miracle. *So he threw aside his garment.*

Let Me Take You Through Some Of The Traditions Common In Our Time.

***KNEELING**.*
Kneeling With A Proud Heart.

As far as kneeling, when praying, is a good tradition and shows humility but here is a fact to consider seriously.
If the knees are at the lowest position or point but our hearts are lifted up in pride; they are far from humility before GOD and fellow man, that kneeling is in vain. The heart should be the first to humble or follow the position of our knees but right inside or within us. Again, If our hearts are lifted up before GOD and our fellow man (*that Lucifer kneeling style*) then that kneeling is not humility. If our hearts carry pride, what is the difference with that spiritual heart of Lucifer?

For you have said in your heart: 'I will ascend into heaven, I will exalt my throne above the stars of God; I will also sit on the mount of the congregation On the farthest sides of the north;
Isaiah 14:13 NKJV

(That was the clear picture of his heart).
Therefore, no matter the posture he showed before GOD during worship but what was inside mattered. It gave birth to rebellion and that fall.

In our case, it is far much better to pray while standing but with a humble heart. Lucifer's sin of pride gave birth to rebellion and the rest is history. Never underestimate the sin of pride. It can hinder our prayers. Pride has spiritual children even when the knees are bowed down in prayer before the Lord. That kneeling will not cover up those children. They will surely be manifested at one time or another. It is not strange that some of the people who rebel against a true Church had their knees bow in prayer at one time or the other. But their hearts had pride; they did not bow like their knees but got lifted up. At one time, a child called rebellion came into birth and the congregation was scattered. It was caused by the same people who had their knees bow down as a tradition but not from their hearts.
Witches, thugs, murderers, adulterers and other sinners also kneel down.

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

His school of thought was strange but important. He was supposed to meet Jesus covered with his garment but he did what was contrary. David was supposed to face Goliath armored with the king's military attire but he just did the opposite. What is your tradition?

CLOSING THE EYES.
Closing The Eyes While The Eyes Of Our Hearts Are Not Closed To The Outside World.

Many people have a tradition of closing their eyes when praying. Some do this to make sure that nothing disturbs them.

If the eyes are closed yet the eyes of your heart are shopping in a shopping mall or a plaza, it is better to open them. It is called hypocrisy.
It's far much better to open your physical eyes but the eyes of your heart closed to the world. Let the eyes of your heart be opened to the throne of GOD in Heaven.

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

GOING TO THE MOUNTAIN FOR PRAYERS.
Going To The Mountain To Pray But Your Heart And Thoughts Are At Home Or In The City.

Sometimes, we go into a lonely place or to a particular mountain to pray. It feels good because we want to stay away from disturbances; from the noise of cups, plate and the sound of radios and television. We want to stay away from the noise of the nock of that notorious creditor.

I have gone to the mountains to pray on a number of times. I once went to pray at the base of one of the biggest mountains in Africa (*and the biggest in my country).* We travelled from this city to another district. We had a sister- in- the Lord to pay a visit but also go for prayers.
I also went into another mountain for a three- day fasting alone. I stayed in that mountain three days and nights. Sometimes, it was so lonely at night and I was sleeping in a cave with a candle nearby for some light. I have, on a number of occasions, gone with brothers and sisters into the mountains to pray, especially during *prayers and fasting.*
But we should not forget that the Master commanded us to enter into our room; close the door and pray secretly. He also taught us to avoid vain repetitions.

[***6] "But you, when you pray, go into your room, and when you have shut your door, pray to your Father who is in the secret place; and your Father who sees in secret will reward you openly. [7] "And when you pray, do not use vain repetitions as the heathen do. For they think that they will be heard for their many words.***

Matthew 6:6-7 NKJV

He also commanded us to worship GOD in spirit and truth.
This is what he said:

21] Jesus said to her, "Woman, believe Me, the hour is coming when you will neither on this mountain, nor in Jerusalem, worship the Father. [22] "You worship [what you do not know; we know what we worship, for salvation is of the Jews. [23] "But the hour is coming, and now is, when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and truth; for the Father is seeking such to worship Him. [24] "God is Spirit, and those who worship Him must worship in spirit and truth."
John 4:21-24 NKJV

You should not forget that prayer is part of worship.

Therefore, tradition against truth can enslave a person but truth against such tradition, will set a person free.
In short, truth sets us free and Jesus(the word of GOD) is Truth.

If you are in the mountains praying while your mind is in the city; into a football pitch or a soccer field then it's better to pray at home. Others watch football in their minds while their bodies are far away to the mountains. But let me take you to this fact: a person can pray with a broken heart and tears nearly coming out. This can be done secretly and in spirit and truth. This can happen while in the middle of the noise of minibus passengers. But since it's secret, it can be like a closed room or door; no one is listening but GOD only. It's close to that prayer of Hannah, the mother of Samuel. Such kind of believers can have their prayers reach the throne of GOD. Their petitions can be in a better position to receive an answer than that person far away to the wilderness or the mountain while the heart or thoughts are in the city or at home. Secrecy, discipline and seriousness will matter in prayer. GOD is a serious GOD. Have you ever heard Jesus or the Apostles joking as we do today even during prayer time or preaching?

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

Are you not surprised that not all who pray are receiving their answers? To say the truth, we are supposed to get our petitions answered? Should GOD be serious with a person who is not serious but prays jokingly? GOD, Jesus, the Holy Spirit, the Angels never joke and the apostles never joked too. Will you joke or not be serious when the adversary has wounded you down the floor? Will you smile at (or tolerate) Malaria?
You should be wise and learn to please the truth of the Bible and not tradition. If you have the truth and alone, you are in a far better position than the majority following common tradition. Again, you should be wise. You should follow the truth and not tradition.

The Bible warns that:

[8] 'These people draw near to Me with their mouth, And honor Me with their lips, But their heart is far from Me. [9] And in vain they worship Me, Teaching as doctrines the commandments of men.' "

Matthew 15:8-9 NKJV

It is necessary to check the attention of our hearts during prayer time. We can pray in a remote place to draw near to GOD but in vain.

The Tradition.

Bartimaeus threw aside his garment. He threw aside the tradition in order to meet the Master and receive his sight.

Do you remember that the woman with the issue of blood had to throw aside a garment of some protocol in order to get her healing? That protocol could have pushed her to the graveyard before her time. She had to throw aside her garment or the protocol. She replaced it with faith and it worked supernaturally. But tradition looks and feels good yet, can hinder a great miracle.

ESTHER'S THREE- DAY FASTING.

Taking The Fasting Of Esther As A Tradition While Leaving Out The Guidance Of The Holy Spirit.

It is *good* to copy a *good* thing. Therefore, copying Esther's three- day fasting is *good* too. But taking Esther's fasting as a tradition can be wrong. Some people think that GOD will answer them If the fasting has taken many days or it is long. It does not work like that unless it is the will of GOD.

It should work according to the will or the guidance of the Lord. Any fasting guided and done according to His will is fruitful. It will yield great results whether it's long or short, completely dry or just skipping some stuff. You should do exactly according to the will and guidance of the Holy Spirit

On the other hand, I encourage you not to stop fasting but you should do it the right way. There is a good reason GOD wants you to fast but do it according to His guidance and will; not according to tradition.

I also fasted for three years although changing the patterns within those years. Sometimes, for thirty days (drinking something and some snacks in the evening). Sometimes, fasting a single day per week and later forty seven days(breaking the fast every evening) until three years ended. To me, the fasting itself was not difficult but the commitment that those three years should be set apart for a journey of fasting. I felt so strongly to do that kind of fasting and I invited other brothers and sisters to join me. I am not saying this for praise but to convince you that the author of this book has gone through the same journey. He has some experience on the topic. He knows what he is writing about. I started fasting while I was in secondary school.

I once fasted for three days without food or water while doing heavy work at home. That was part of the beginning of my journey of fasting and I was a secondary school student that time.

Therefore, I want you to do it to your best and receive your answers. I mean, *doing it the supernatural way*, according to the guidance and will of GOD not according to tradition. It's really painful to fast for thirty days but don't see any results. If fasting was an exam, would you get a distinction? if the finger of GOD marked it, would it really pass that exam? We should be excellent even in prayer and fasting.

Moses, David, Elijah, Daniel, Esther and the Jews fasted; the Lord Jesus and the apostles fasted too.

Therefore, fasting is good and commendable but it should be done according to the will and guidance of the Lord. It should not be done according to tradition.

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

Think about worshiping GOD in vain or fasting in vain. You cannot afford to skip a full chicken in the name of fasting and miss the right formula then your answer. That should sound painful.
By the way, I like traditional chicken and foodstuffs but not traditional fasting.
So, I started the journey of fasting since my secondary school. I know what I am talking about. I have also done a complete five- day dry fasting (*no food and no water*). Around the Jewish holy feasts of Rosh Hashanah and Atonement, we also take a fast. So I know what I am talking about. One time, my check was delayed. I was working for a big company that time. I took a fast by skipping delicious food during lunch time. I presented my sorrow before the Heavenly Father. It did not take long and my check was released.

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

The Tradition.

Therefore, fasting should not overrun or replace the will and guidance of the Holy Spirit accompanied by our faith.
You should not do Esther's fasting traditionally and with self- centeredness. Esther had all the Jews at heart. If you do it in the wrong way, that fasting will go in vain.

Sometimes, we take Esther's three- day fast so that we may get employment, a car, promotion at work, a beautiful home and other things; there is nothing wrong with that. We all want good and decent things even the way of travel and a place to call our own home on (*this temporary)* Earth.
But first, you could take a three- day fast and pray for the children who are in the ICU; who are caught up between life and death. If you fasted for the women who are travelling long distances without food and water and carrying little children on their backs. Some of their human- rights advocates have never passed through that pain. They live in beautiful homes and appear only on TV to comment about them. They have more funding than the victims they speak for; the victims have no food, no water and no place to call a home. They are in the bush and on their way to a strange land.
Those who cause these unnecessary wars have many bodyguards taking care of them and their families. They have plenty of provisions and a fleet of cars plus some airplanes. It's sad and shocking to call this a civilized society. It's almost impossible to have a civilized society with an evil- spiritual foundation. That foundation matters. Otherwise, they will meet secretly to cause a devastating war yet advocating for peace in the physical. The latter is hypocrisy. Some of these wars are not prophetic; they are deliberate and selfish wars. They could be avoided through love. *Let's love one another for GOD is love.*
So these refugees are running away from such conflicts and we should pray for them and for peace. A refugee today can be a free citizen tomorrow and a free citizen today can be a refugee tomorrow. Things are changing fast. Let's love one another and pray for peace.
If we fasted for the mad person who is wandering up and down the streets and has not eaten for some days. This person could have been a great doctor but the Enemy attacked him. *If we fasted for him to be rescued and restored.* If we fasted for the thousands of young women who are in bondage due to human trafficking and are abused day and night. Some are abused sexually over twenty times a day and without escape. If you took

that fast for all the youth in the universities. Some of them have no tuition and even a laptop. Some are passing through different challenges including mental health or stress.
If we fasted for the salvation of all sinners in this world.
If we fasted for the peace of Jerusalem and that there should not be Third World War.
If we fasted for the right people to rule this world which is on the verge of sinking. It only takes the grace and mercy of GOD that we are still living.
I assure you, if we had put these priorities first then pray for our beautiful car, home and promotion at work; they would still be given to us. We have become a brother's keeper.
If we have aligned our priorities correctly, just like Esther, the other needs will surely be met.
We really need a beautiful car and home but don't forget to pray for the peace of the world. If you miss that, where will you drive that car? You could end up at the border with a few utensils crossing over into another country? If things become extreme, the car will be left behind and walking on foot. Have you ever thought about that. Other things are inextricably linked. Lets do things by the will and guidance of the Lord. We should not do them traditionally.

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

It's wise to think and prioritize the mad man who has malaria, has no home, is hungry and has no care. Believers who have food, shelter, bank accounts, cars and families should put their priorities first and leave out this mad man? Unless our challenges are far beyond that mad person.
King Solomon had Israel and the will of GOD at heart. Esther had the Jews at heart.
King Solomon asked for wisdom but riches and honor were added to him. We should check the priorities of our fasting. I challenge Christians all over the world to revisit the way fasting is done in our time.
The Bible says that:

"But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things shall be added to you.

Matthew 6:33 NKJV

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

The Tradition.

The Story Of Bartimaeus- The Son Of Timaeus.

The fasting of Esther should not be copied by the number of days only; *it will turn into a tradition*. *But it should also be copied by its priorities.*
In our case, the first priority should be the will of GOD. The second should be that of a brother's keeper. Another will of GOD is that we should love others as we love ourselves for GOD is love. We should stand in the gap for others and place our priorities on the third position. GOD will still bless and provide for us even before we present our petitions.

Again, GOD gave Solomon more than what he asked for because of his priority in his prayers. But this seems difficult in our time. It's me and my family not that child fighting for survival in the I.C.U. *We have our own needs and priorities but let's show love to others even through our prayers and fasting.*

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

The tradition.

HOLDING A CROSS- OVER NIGHT OF PRAYER.
We Should Not Abandon The Leading Of The Holy Spirit Through The Year And Choose A Cross- Over Prayer Meeting.

The tradition of holding Cross- Over Night Of Prayers, *at the end of each year, is a good idea.*
But if we just take it as a tradition; not from the Spirit of the Lord and not by faith, nothing can change over the coming year. Things may change for better or to the best only by the grace and the abundant mercies of the Lord. Again, if our priority is that GOD should give us material blessings but leaving out that child struggling in the ICU or the salvation of the sinner then we should revisit our responsibility on Earth. If we have nothing to do with the will of God but our own will then something has to be corrected.
"*My car, my house, my money, my visa, my position…" and the list goes on.* You can imagine getting them but missing something greater than a car or house? Think about missing a great mansion in the life to come; in Paradise? In short, receiving a car, an airplane and a beautiful home is good but missing Heaven and all its glory should be the worst disaster. This will likely happen if we prioritize the flesh over the spirit, this world over Heaven but above all- our will over that of GOD. Think about those suffering more than us but have no one to carry their burdens or pray for them.
We should seek to live a good life here on Earth but also to persevere during persecution. We will face trials on Earth just like Jesus and the apostles. But above that, we should make sure not to miss Heaven and all its glory. We should not receive a car here on Earth and miss a beautiful mansion in Heaven.

The Tradition.

That is why, regardless of the thousands of *Cross- Over Night Of Prayers* towards every New Year but troubles seem not to cease. They are still hitting this world and nearly sinking it. It is only held strongly by *GOD Himself and for His purpose.*
Sometimes, we point to many things happening as a result of the end of the world. There is Bible prophecy about the troubles we are going to face as the world comes to an end. The word of GOD will not return to Him void(Is 55:11).
But some of these troubles we are facing are a result of doing things traditionally. We are doing things not by the way or will of the Holy Spirit. We have replaced the will of GOD with tradition. We have replaced the guidance and direction of the Holy Spirit with money and other physical resources. In other words, we are making programs (even in ministry)

due to availability of money and other physical resources. We have abandoned or put aside the guidance and will of the Holy Spirit.
It is not strange that many are crying for global revival but neglecting the individual revivals. Many are eager for a global revival to happen but never mind about how we lost the past revivals. This stocktaking is vital because it will help us put our houses in a good order. When we are corrected and well positioned, we will not lose again the revival that we anticipate. This is wisdom.
So, it's good and beautiful to hold *Cross- Over Night Of Prayers*. Let's continue holding them with joyful hearts. But from now on, let's not do it as a tradition. We should always seek the will of the Holy Spirit. Some of you will be shocked at what GOD will reveal or lead you to do. If these beautiful prayers are done carefully, with the guidance of the Holy Spirit, Heaven will be opened on Earth. There are a lot of people who have been attending these beautiful prayers but have not yet experienced change. We should seek the guidance of the Lord and check our priorities.
It should be led and guided by the Spirit of the Lord. It should be Spirit over tradition and the life to come over the present life. In other words, Heaven over Earth. Again, those suffering, even more than us, over our desires. Above all, the will of GOD over our own will. If we put priorities in the right place, position and formula we will start seeing that desired change. Heaven will be opened on Earth instead of Hell getting loose over this world.
You should remember, the Bible says that, if we ask anything according to the will of GOD, He will hear us.

Now this is the confidence that we have in Him, that if we ask anything according to His will, He hears us.

1 John 5:14 NKJV

The tradition.

I am looking forward to the time when we will not be conducting such prayers traditionally but by the Spirit of GOD; not by our own will but by the will of GOD as a priority, not in December only but from January to December.
In short, according to the direction or guidance of the Spirit of the Lord and not according to tradition.

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

If we work on these, I am so sure that we will receive more than what we ask from the Lord. Again, think about those suffering across the world. Think about the refugee who is sick and the madman along the street- who is hungry and has malaria. Let's stand in the gap for the nations and repent on their behalf.
Pray for the salvation of the sinner and for Revival on Earth. We should pray not to miss Heaven. We should pray for the world leaders that they should rule according to the will of God. The Enemy is trying to set up leaders to govern the world according to his own

will. There are many strange agendas meant to destroy humanity and change the course of this world.
Yes, leaders are chosen by GOD and it is supposed to be so. But the agenda of man and Satan needs leadership of their own choice. GOD can allow man over his own way or choice without forcing him into His will. But to us, no matter what happens, all things will work for our own good because we love GOD.

So the Bible warns that:

"They set up kings, but not by Me; They made princes, but I did not acknowledge them. From their silver and gold They made idols for themselves— That they might be cut off.
Hosea 8:4 NKJV

Therefore, let's pray for our leaders. As man and Satan work to influence the choice of leadership in this world, we should also stand for the will of GOD. This can be done during or through Cross- Over Night Of Prayers.
We should also remember to pray for the peace of Jerusalem.

What about this special prayer point in the bible?
Watch therefore, and pray always that you may be counted worthy to escape all these things that will come to pass, and to stand before the Son of Man."

Luke 21:36 (NKJV).
What a beautiful prayer point.

After the will of GOD and those suffering then ask Him that you want that car, a beautiful home, healthy life, a PhD, promotion at work and a beautiful marriage. GOD will give them to you and make sure to use them for His glory. Help the work of GOD, use that car to pick others to church or to a prayer meeting. You should pick a stranded pregnant woman to hospital and use it to visit those in prison. In short, use it to the glory of GOD. Let your family, neighbors and the needy be blessed through it and glorify GOD. You should use your money to bless your family and make sure that your children have a bright future financially. But also, pay tuition for that refugee and that orphan. You should remove that homeless person from the street. Do not forget to stand with the true workers or ministers of GOD.
He will not refuse to give you such wealth, blessings and finances. *They are for good works; for His will or purpose. GOD is love.*
Again, let's check the purposes and priorities of our prayers.

Therefore, the will of GOD should come above our own will. Think about those suffering in this world. You have your own needs and you should present them before the Lord.
Let's choose "***the will of GOD***" formula and see if He will not answer us the way He answered king Solomon although not with the same kind of blessings. But even those things he did not ask for, they were given to him. He will answer you and me before we finish our prayers.

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

The Tradition.

THE TRADITION OF DRAWING A CROSS OVER THE CHEST DURING PRAYERS.
Drawing A Cross Over The Chest When It Is Not The Cross Of Jesus.

The tradition of drawing a cross over your chest, during prayers, is a common practice. But I would like to draw your attention to the fact that there are a number of major crosses used in the world.
Some of them are:
The Scientology, a non- Christian cross; the Canterbury Cross, the Forked Cross, the Gnostic Cross, the Papal Cross, the Latin Cross, the Russian Orthodox or Suppedaneum Cross, the Greek Cross, the Celtic Cross, the Coptic Ankh, Calvary, Crucifix, the Plague Cross, the Cross of Constantine (with the Greek letters Chi(X) and Rho(P) or the symbol ☧), the Tau Cross, St. Peter's Cross, the Maltese Cross etc.
When you make a sign over your chest, during prayers, have you ever asked which cross you are drawing? Have you ever verified that the figure drawn is really a cross? Is it really the Cross of the Lord Jesus?
One time, try to take a pen or pencil and a plain paper. You should draw a line from the top to the bottom; cross it over to the left of the diagram and finally to the right. You may check if the drawing will be a cross? *If it is not a cross and not the Cross of the Lord Jesus then what is that diagram or drawing?* What is the spiritual meaning and its spiritual effect to the believer? You may also ask where it was practiced in the Bible? Did the apostles make that sign?
I leave the rest with you to find out the correct answer.

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

The Tradition.

SPEAKING IN TONGUES, IN A PUBLIC PRAYER, WITHOUT INTERPRETATION.

Speaking In Tongues, In Church, Without Interpretation When The Bible Makes It Clear On The Topic.

The tradition of speaking in tongues, by believers, is so common but not all the tongues are from the Holy Spirit. Don't say I did not warn you.
If tongues are strange (*not from the Holy Spirit*), they can either destroy you or another person.
When you speak the language of the world, some have to understand or interpret it. When you speak the language of Heaven, again, another person should interpret the same. But most of the tongues today are without interpretation. They are short and the same or repeated words.

Brethren, this is not supposed to be in that way.
Our GOD is a GOD of order and not confusion. That is why some believers have been wounded and the Fire of the Lord quenched. We have to be careful. The apostle Paul warned:
[5] I wish you all spoke with tongues, but even more that you prophesied; for he who prophesies is greater than he who speaks with tongues, unless indeed he interprets, that the church may receive edification.
[27] If anyone speaks in a tongue, let there be two or at the most three, each in turn, and let one interpret. [28] But if there is no interpreter, let him keep silent in church, and let him speak to himself and to God. [29] Let two or three prophets speak, and let the others judge.

1 Corinthians 14:5,27-29

Brothers and sisters, is this a difficult teaching? We run away from the Old Testament saying that it is for Israel or for the Jews. But we do not follow the teachings of the New Testament as well. Which doctrine is for you and me today?
The story of Bartimaeus- the son of Timaeus.

He Threw Aside His Garment.

The Tradition.

THE TRADITION OF SAYING, "AMEN."
When You Say "Amen" After A Wrong Doctrine, Prayer And Wrong Tongues.

The tradition of saying "*AMEN*" feels good in order to affirm a prayer or statement. This happens when there are two parties and it acts as an agreement between the two..
But I don't think I should say "Amen" when I am praying alone. I do not need to say "*AMEN*" to myself. But between two parties. Apart from that fact, I would like to warn on the same. If a prayer has been made in tongues, which have not been interpreted, it is dangerous to endorse it with an "*AMEN*." What if the tongue is not from the Spirit of the Lord and it's a negative word towards your soul? Do you agree or endorse that word of death or calamity through that tongue? Tongues which are not from the Holy Spirit are not for your well- being.
If a sermon is a false doctrine and you add an "*AMEN*" to that false teaching, it will become a self- made trouble or a spiritual destruction. Do you see the danger? You have to be careful with your "*AMEN*." Be spiritually economical with it; calculating it carefully. Do not just spend this treasurer anyhow. It will leave you with wounds.
You should avoid using it as a tradition but with wisdom from Heaven. If you take this warning seriously, you will be blessed instead of being destroyed by the same "*Amen*."
Say, "Amen."

Many people will regret on the Judgment Day. They will find out that the Enemy used a simple tradition to hinder them from the kingdom of GOD. Do not end up into the Lake of Fire because of a particular tradition even that of an "Amen."

Bartimaeus Threw Aside His Garment.

The Tradition.

THIS TRADITION IN POLITICS.

When the campaign period begins, it is likely to see supporters holding a banner or placard. Some of the writing is about beautiful and praise messages to their leaders. But other words are cruel and judgmental against the opponent. Some of these placards and posters are held up and even higher by believers. *It could have been better to lift higher the name of the Lord Jesus or the holy Bible.* But, unfortunately, it's a political placard. It's lifted up by those that call on the name of the Lord; those who praised the Lord on the previous worship service.
We should remember that the Lord will appear or the Rapture can take place at anytime. This can happen while that banner, with cursing words, is still in your hands. Where will that journey end? My brothers and sisters, it should not be like that. We are supposed to be led by the Spirit of the Lord and not by anger, revenge or evil. We are supposed to be led by love. *GOD is love.* It's time to change. We should be peace makers and a brother's keeper. A Republican should not go to Hell because of hatred against a Democrat. On the other hand, a Democrat should also not go to Hell because of hatred towards a Republican. We were all created in the image of GOD and we should be a brother's keeper.
Let's love one another for GOD is love. He loved us while we were sinners. Why can't we love a fellow human being in the same condition or state? *Again, GOD is love*.

THIS TRADITION IN SPORTS.

You should imagine the final game of an important tournament and the final whistle is about to blow. You are holding a vuvuzela like your god and full of hatred against the referee and another supporter. Your face is sweating in search of worldly and a temporary victory called a score or a goal. But the Master appears suddenly, like lightening, in the skies.
Will you really go to Heaven?
We should love Heaven more than the worldly glory. The former is eternal but the latter will fade away.
[***13] making the word of God of no effect through your tradition which you have handed down. And many such things you do."***
Mark 7:13

Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, threw aside his garment. He moved to meet the Master and received his great miracle.

The Tradition.

THE STORY OF NAAMAN.

[***11] But Naaman became furious, and went away and said, "Indeed, I said to myself, 'He will surely come out to me, and stand and call on the name of the Lord his God, and wave his hand over the place, and heal the leprosy.'***
2 Kings 5:11(NKJV).

Where did he see or learn that kind of prayer? He nearly missed a great miracle. *That imaginary tradition in his thoughts made him to be proud, stubborn and judgmental.*
Tradition makes the word of GOD to be of no effect (Mark 7:13). This has become a weapon in the hand of the Enemy to hinder the supernatural from the Lord.

Bartimaeus, The Son Of Timaeus, Threw Aside His Garment.

The Tradition.

Let me remind you something before I finish this part.
Here is the prayer of our Lord Jesus Christ at the tomb of Lazarus:

[***40] Jesus said to her, "Did I not say to you that if you would believe you would see the glory of God?" [41] Then they took away the stone from the place where the dead man was lying. And Jesus lifted up His eyes and said, "Father, I thank You that You have heard Me. [42] And I know that You always hear Me, but because of the people who are standing by I said this, that they may believe that You sent Me." [43] Now when He had said these things, He cried with a loud voice, "Lazarus, come forth!"***
John 11:40-43

Lazarus came back to life.
No opening and closing prayer.
No kneeling.
No closing of eyes.
No making of any sign over the face and chest.
No saying "Amen."
But one of the greatest miracles of resurrection took place.

Bartimaeus threw aside his garment.

May GOD bless you exceedingly.

YOUR HOPE IS NOT LOST.

IV. LIFE LESSONS- PART IV.

In our life lesson part 1V, we are going to see the spot of the encounter or the spot of the event.
Scripture reference is taken from Verse 46 of Mark 10.

46 Now they came to Jericho. As He went out of Jericho with His disciples and a great multitude, blind Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, sat by the road begging.

He sat by the road begging.

Note: ***BY THE ROAD.***

Although this seems a minor issue to consider but it played an important role in this great and one- time encounter. What could happen if the Lord Jesus passed through Jericho and Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, just missed the right spot? That spot he met the greatest healer from Nazareth. The Bible calls it- ***by the road.***

If Jesus was passing by this road but Bartimaeus was another side, the man could have died still blind unless by the great mercies of GOD. Something happened ***by the road.***

The spot was important and played a unique role in this life- time encounter and great miracle.

Today, many lives have been destroyed, marriages scattered, some are in prison, some on the way to Paradise and others to Hell because of the spot they were found at one time. The marital prison they are fighting to come out today was entered through that wrong spot. They were found at a wrong place and gave birth to this relationship which they are ending today. Thanks to GOD because nothing is impossible with Him. He can bring calm into a situation that came along because of a wrong encounter from a wrong spot. You should always remember Bartimaeus' spot and position yourself well- ***by the road.***

This was for a great blessing. In the Bible, some found it at a well and another person in the bush; another in the field and others at the sea and the list goes on. Their journey to glory began at that point and symbolically- ***by the road.***

Some are singing a song of praise today. They were found at the right place or spot. They met someone who is like an angel and has made life so beautiful and sweet more than sugarcane- ***by the road.***

It was along that road where the Lord Jesus was passing. At that right spot, Bartimaeus met him and received his great and lifetime miracle.

There are some people who have been suffering for some time now. But the source of their suffering is a wrong plot that they once rented. Something went wrong at that plot. They never asked GOD whether it was the right place to stay. Their trouble began right there; *at that place.*

Bartimaeus sat by the road where the Lord Jesus would pass in Jericho.

If he was in Jericho but at a wrong place or spot, that great miracle could have been missed. Jesus could still have passed through that city with Bartimaeus' great miracle. Unfortunately, Bartimaeus could have missed it. They could both be in the same city but separated by his wrong spot. He could have missed that great healing because of a wrong spot. But Bartimaeus placed himself ***by the road;*** the right place.

One of the contributing factors to his healing was that spot. He sat at the right place or spot where Jesus would pass. You should never underestimate that place where you are found. Some have become rich and others in utter poverty because of a particular place. Marriage is a place or spot; work too is a place and the list goes on. Magic and witchcraft also uses a spot to trap a person. Blessings, healing and restoration can also find a person through the right place or spot. You should be conscious about the place you are found. It can be for a blessing or a curse; for life or death. It can also be for a good marriage or prison of marriage. But GOD is kind and merciful. You can always seek the guidance of the Spirit of the Lord. We are supposed to be guided and led by Him.

The Bible says that:

Seek the LORD while He may be found, Call upon Him while He is near.
Isaiah 55:6 NKJV

Seeking the Lord ***where*** he may be found means the right place.
If you care about your destiny or the right goal, the following facts should matter:

Your friends should be connected to that destiny.
Your wife or husband should be connected to your destiny.
You should have some knowledge, education or training pointing to that destiny.
Your employment or workplace should be connected to the same destiny.
You should be living in a place which is towards that destiny- ***by the road.***

Otherwise, you will face difficulties to get to that GOD- given destiny.
After my secondary school, I wanted to be a police man, specifically CID, just like my father. But my cousin stopped me from taking that path when I was invited for interviews. My other cousin was a Muslim and he got scholarship to Pakistan. Our cousin stopped him again and he was not happy. He wanted to go to Pakistan. When the second opportunity came, he did not ask for any advice from him. He just arranged for everything and went to Turkey. He came back to Malawi, worked in government as project coordinator for a Development Corridor. He later became our country's Ambassador to the Gulf region. He passed on some years ago. I miss him because we grew up like twins. But for me, I was diverted from becoming a policeman. As a young man with a destiny in ministry, I have good understanding now about what happened.
Since then, the main companies I worked for; the work had to do with standing. I worked in a big shoe factory, firstly at a conveyor and always standing. Later, I worked as an internal buyer but mostly, it was traveling between the factory and the buying department. It was not sitting but walking between departments and standing as though a bonus to that. Any slight mistake, the machines for making military boots, plastic shoes, sleepers, men's and ladies shoes; machines for making gumboots, for making school shoes and other products would stop.
The factory manager, a French man, would search for me to arouse my attention. This was done to ensure that both the heavy and light machines were working and the conveyors delivering shoes. We were two employees for that work and the entire factory relied on us for the supplies. We had to communicate well with the foremen of all sections and coordinated on supplies- ***by the road.***
Sometime later, I was transferred to the retail department as a salesman having knowledge of shoe production or process. I was so happy because I was going to be out of the factory and to a better place without seeing factory smoke. Many shops were along main town roads and city streets. I could not miss smoke from the car exhausts or the tailpipe and their sounds. But I was away from the sound of the factory machines. Along this journey, I still missed the police work, especially CID.
At the retail shop, as it involved serving customers, it was about standing again. We were allowed to sit when the shop was quiet but mostly, it was standing. After that, I became a relief shop manager and finally, a retail branch manager for an executive outlet in my

country. But it was through standing. I was a backslidden believer then but still prayed to the Lord.
There were only few of that type or standard of retail branches in Africa. By the grace of GOD, I was one of the best retail branch managers in my country.
I was now free from long times of standing and not knowing that in my heavenly assignment ahead, it would be some standing again. But I was free now as a manager. As a retail branch manager, I could stand but not consistently.
Sometime later, I left that shoe world and got employment with another company. Before they offered me a position of Plantation Manager later, I used to stand in the factory. I could stand from morning to evening or from evening to morning- *standing again*. I used to work during the day and on night shifts. We could rest during official breaks including lunchtime. The same as I do with prayer meetings today- *day or night* and involving standing while the congregation is sitting and listening to the sermon.

Standing Again.

So, I had to work while standing and close to a dangerous conveyor. If I dozed, it could be a disaster as I could fall over it and lose some of my body parts. It was so dangerous and I had to be alert while *standing again.* But I managed to stand through the night and not falling at any time though tired. When writing a report, I did recommend something towards the night shifts. It was a well- written report with good suggestions for the well-being of some staff and the safety of their products. It was a good report indeed and introduced a new system to protect their products.
But my work was terminated later. After sometime, I was offered a higher position of a Plantation Manager with a car attached. It involved driving and travelling. I had no driving license and lost that great opportunity. By then, I was also doing music and a vice chairman of the musician's body in the southern chapter- ***by the road.***
The time of the last work incident pushed me to my full- time ministry. I was also offered the position of a sales representative by another firm but I did not go for that. I wanted to do full- time ministry and I started it without normal procedures.
Along my journey, *as a minister of the Good News of salvation to this sinking world*, I have understood why my elder cousin stopped me from joining the police. On the other hand, why I had passed through that work process. It had to do with my destiny and some was my preparation- ***by the road.***

I was feeding the entire factory with production materials. If I delayed or not supplied, the conveyors would stop and production too.
At the retail outlets, I was serving customers and convincing some to make the right choices. I was also guiding others to alternative or related designs.
At the second company, I was working day and night and being so conscious, sober or alert in order to avert danger but mostly, standing. (The full story is found in the other book- The Great Story Of Boldness and Courage. It is under the heading- My Journey From Music To Ministry...).

Your life today, should fit in to the destiny that GOD has for you in this life and that to come- *from family, career, friendships, other connections and places*- ***by the road.***
Place yourself at the right place and on the right spot- ***by the road.***

A place or spot where Jesus is passing along with your destiny and your marriage. Where he is passing with your healing and breakthrough.

Through my preparation process, I did not realise or understand that my heavenly recruitment would involve standing most of the times. It would involve standing while on duty or ministering.
My legs were trained unawares for the work I am doing now. *The work of full- time ministry*.
If my cousin did not stop me from joining the police, I do not know where I could end up as a police officer. I desired to be in the CID. A young lady who came from school with me and joined the police then, retired some years ago as an Assistant Commissioner of police. But now, I realise that what I was passing through was just *Bartimaeus' spot-* ***by the road****.*
I was placed at the right place in order to meet the Lord Jesus for the great miracle of my ministry. You are reading or holding, in your hands, one of the fruits of my great miracle received at that place or spot- ***by the road****.*

You are not married or want to get married? If the answer is yes then seek the right spot. Your right husband or wife may just be passing through that *street, spot, event, function* or through your connection at that right place. Your attention will be captured for that awaited marriage- ***by the road.***
In other words, the right provider of the right husband or the right wife will be passing with your great miracle. Therefore, place yourself on the right spot like Bartimaeus- the son of Timaeus- ***by the road.***
Never underestimate the place you are found, it can be for good or bad, for a blessing or curse, for sickness or healing, for life or death; to meet the Lord Jesus or the Enemy and finally, for Paradise or Hell. The choice is with you- ***by the road.***
That was why Mary, when she was conceived, she went to the right place and to the right person called *Elizabeth. S*he was also conceived to give birth to John the Baptist- ***by the road.***
They were cousins and both pregnant to give birth to great figures of this world and the universe.
That's how it is supposed to be- ***by the road.***
May you find your right spot or place for your great miracle.

YOUR HOPE IS NOT LOST.
THE STORY OF BARTIMAEUS- THE SON OF TIMAEUS.

V. LIFE LESSONS- PART V.

HE STARTED THE DAY WITH BLINDNESS BUT ENDED IT WITH CLEAR SIGHT.

In the first part, I explained that the day looked ordinary in the physical. But in the spiritual realm, something great was in waiting. Things were ordinary and nothing showed that a great teacher would pass along with his great miracle. It looked a normal day. But in the spiritual realm, something spectacular was in making for the blind man of Jericho. I warned that we have to be careful how we handle our days. Some days may look ordinary but in the spirit realm or on the calendar of GOD, that day may not be ordinary.

Others have already missed such great days because of the bad mood they carried along. *But GOD is faithful. Pray that the Lord will restore to you that great parcel you missed.* We should learn to handle our days carefully; not allowing our circumstances to stop us from receiving our answers or blessings. *GOD is good; all the time.*

Let's handle our days with much consciousness about this. You may not know what GOD has in store for you or what is hidden behind a particular day.

He heard and verified that the Man passing along was Jesus of Nazareth.
In the second part, I said that Bartimaeus had mastered Jesus before they met. So the issue about Jesus did not just come up on that particular day. It was in his heart, running in his mind, flowing through his blood and when they met, he just blew up what was already built up in him. In short, the man was well prepared before he met J*esus* of Nazareth and his faith was already in the right place or position. I have heard or watched stories of people who went for a prayer meeting but when the time of prayer came along, they had already run away. *They were present but not prepared and ready*.
Bartimaeus was present and ready but without an usher or usherette to arrange things for him before Jesus. There was not even a prayer protocol put in place or arranged. On the other hand, no one could stop him.

He Started The Day With Blindness But Ended It With Clear Sight.

That is the life lesson- part V.

The day did not end the way it started. Something changed along the way and based on the presence and an encounter with Jesus Of Nazareth.
So, in part two, I did show or indicate that his mention of Jesus with the titles of "***Son of David" and "Rabboni"*** shows that he had heard and knew something about the Master and the greatest healer.
In part three, I talked about throwing aside his garment which I referred to as tradition. Many people in the world, even fellow Christians, are led or influenced and controlled by different traditions. These traditions have affected their spiritual lives while hindering that supernatural experience from the Holy Spirit. You may check that tradition in your prayer life or spiritual walk. It might be very close or similar to that garment that Bartimaeus had put aside and let the supernatural happen. I listed a number such traditions. These are some of the ways we like doing things and stick to them but are not even found in the Bible. But they are loved dearly by Bible teachers, pastors, evangelists, apostles, prophets, intercessors and others. That is why we do not see the great supernatural acts frequently and hear the world say: "***This is the finger of GOD,"*** like the time of Moses from the mouth of the magicians in Egypt (Ex 8: 19). The time when GOD had humbled them. We do not hear people saying, like those of Nain: "***God has vis*ited *His people.***" (Luke 7:16).
The tradition.

Life Lessons- part V.

The Day Started With Blindness But Ended With Clear Sight.

The day that GOD visited Abram, we are not told how that day started. But the good news is that by the end of that day, he had received a message of the land of his inheritance.
The entire Canaan and stretching from the river of Egypt to the great river Euphrates.

On the same day the LORD made a covenant with Abram, saying: "To your descendants I have given this land, from the river of Egypt to the great river, the River Euphrates.

Gen 15:18(NKJV).

On the day that Noah was told to build an Ark, we are not told about how that day started. But the good news is that it ended with the hope of deliverance. That hope came through the word of GOD by his obedience to build that Ark.
On the day that GOD met Moses, we are not told how that day began in that community of Midian or the household of Jethro. But the good news is that, along the way of that particular day, he met GOD.
This goes on in the Bible even to the time that the Angel Gabriel met Mary, the mother of our Lord Jesus. We do not know the circumstances around Mary on that particular day. We do not know how that day began; *the day of Good News to the whole world.* But the interesting story is that she heard *glad tidings about the birth of Jesus.*
What a special message on a day that looked so ordinary in the physical but so great spiritually? Be careful how you handle each day in your life. Do not even allow the Enemy to spoil your day if it starts badly. The day that seems to be bad can turn out to be one of the best days in your life, by the grace of GOD. Do not judge a day based on how it has started or the way you see it. You never know the spiritual side. We are instructed to walk by faith and not by sight. It happened to Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, the blind man of Jericho.
He started his day with the same blindness but ended it with clear sight.

Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, went into begging while blind but came back with clear sight and free from the disgrace of begging in Jericho. *It was a double- portion blessing*.

Some days can begin with debts but can be the same day that GOD can ordain to make you debt free. Some days can start with marital conflicts but in the spirit realm, it can be the very day GOD has decided to make you free from long years of marital chaos or disorder. A day can start with utter poverty but can be the very day GOD has determine to make you one of the richest in your community, nation or in your generation. It can start with unemployment yet, in the middle of that day, turn out to be the day that you get employed. We should learn from the story of Bartimaeus. It is wise and advisable not to be discouraged, disappointed, high tempered or take your own life based on how a day has begun. *You will not only miss the point but above all, the salvation, glory and the will of GOD.* It can come to pass that the day which has started with dark clouds, turn out to be the brightest day in your life.
It can be the day of your salvation,
For He says: "In an acceptable time I have heard you, And in the day of salvation I have helped you." Behold, now is the accepted time; behold, now is the day of salvation.
2 Corinthians 6:2 NKJV

It can be your day of healing, joy, peace, glory, strength, restoration, reconciliation, celebration, hope and joy.
Just know how to handle each day with faith. Jesus is alive and your hope is not lost.

The day of Bartimaeus Began With Blindness But Ended With Clear Sight.

Isn't Jesus awesome? Don't we serve a miracle working and loving GOD? Why is your hope lost?

The Story Of Bartimaeus- The Son Of Timaeus.
YOUR HOPE IS NOT LOST.

VI. LIFE LESSONS- PART VI.

MANY WARNED HIM TO BE QUIET.

Regardless of the importance of this great miracle, something nearly shuttered it's doorway.
In this part, the main point is verse 48 of Mark 10.

[***46] Now they came to Jericho. As He went out of Jericho with His disciples and a great multitude, blind Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, sat by the road begging. [47] And when he heard that it was Jesus of Nazareth, he began to cry out and say, "Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me!" [48] Then many warned him to be quiet; but he cried out all the more, "Son of David, have mercy on me!" [49] So Jesus***

stood still and commanded him to be called. Then they called the blind man, saying to him, "Be of good cheer. Rise, He is calling you."
Mark 10:46-49 (NKJV)

Then many warned him to be quiet; but he cried out all the more, "Son of David, have mercy on me!"

Why warn him to be quiet?

Who were these people? The disciples or those that knew Bartimaeus? Those that knew the Lord Jesus apart from the disciples? Those who were there just watching that great event? Those who took care of him? We do not know. Why warn him to be quiet? The man was calling on Jesus and with specification of the title- ***Son of David.***
The people who responded are not the one the blind man is calling. They are those who have no healing for him; who are not Jesus. They are not the ***Son of David;*** not ***Rabboni***. Why answer and why stop him? Those were the ones who responded first. Again, not *Jesus the son of David.*
Although the Bible does not describe them here but the points below are clear about them:

They had never passed through blindness before. If they had passed through the same and received sight later, they could encourage him.

They had not passed through the pain this man was passing through. They were stopping him from their comfort zone.

They had never tested the humiliation of begging in Jericho because of blindness.

They had no mercy on him; they never cared about his blindness or his suffering. *It was not about protocol; the Lord Jesus never set any protocols in order to meet him*. He was a humble man and full of compassion.
Those stopping him never cared nor paid any attention to his choice of the word, "***mercy.***" It was so clear and emphasized in his call, "***have mercy on me!"*** The man had a good reason for the choice of the words, *"**have mercy on me!**"* In particular, the word, "***mercy***." He knew that he did not qualify to meet the Master and receive his sight. The only procedure that qualifies him is the Lord's ***mercy***. But they did not listen to him attentively and carefully; they did not examine his statement rooted deep into the foundation of that word, "***mercy***." To them, it was business as usual. But to this blind man of Jericho, it was not business as usual. It was supernatural business from Heaven. It was to be worked through **mercy**.
"***Son of David, have mercy on me!"***
Jesus listened to him carefully and attentively. He understood the man and showed him mercy. He is merciful and that was why that word, "***mercy,"*** was addressed to him.
We should learn to listen to people carefully and attentively. Sometimes, try to add mercy to the people who speak to you or address you.
I believe that Receptionists, Call- Center Personnel, Secretaries, Clinical Officers, Medical Doctors, Judges, Pastors and Politicians are following this part carefully.

If they had mercy on him, they couldn't stop him from calling on Jesus. In fact, they could have encouraged him to do so.
That was why Bartimaeus could not allow people, who had no mercy on him, stop him. He could not be stopped when he wanted to get mercy from the Man who had mercy on him. *He was Jesus of Nazareth.*
Those who had no mercy on him and who were not addressed were the ones who responded first. *They responded faster than the Master.*
Sometimes, when you pray for a financial breakthrough, debts will multiply even faster than ever before. Don't be afraid; don't give up on your faith. GOD is merciful and faithful. In this life, it can happen just like that. You just have to use wisdom and be persistent while casting out fear but holding on to your faith.
You propose a woman for marriage; she is the right person and you are the right man. But before she gives a response and sends you a "*Yes*," the neighbors, her friends, her relatives, and her classmates have already jumped in with a "*No;" not a small one.* In such cases, it only depends upon the will of GOD and known through prayer; do not fight.
"***Son of David, have mercy on me!***"
But their action did not stop Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, from calling on Jesus. It was about him and Jesus. So he did not pay attention to them but to Jesus; the healer and the Savior of this world. The one who even brought life to the dead. Who had the power to bless and multiply food. He had the power, not only to calm the storm but also, to walk on water. He had the power to deliver a mad man from the possession of a legion and once turned water into wine. *He wanted that great Man.*
Why should Bartimaeus give attention and abort his one-time opportunity just because of those men above? He did not listen or pay any attention to them. He knew what he was doing.
If he allowed such people, *who had not passed through what he faced in life*, who could bear that fault? Those people stopping him or Bartimaeus?

You should imagine Satan- *who once lived in Heaven and was there during the time of Adam, Abraham, David to this century*- stopping you from going to Heaven? Do you allow him stop you from meeting Jesus? He lost that opportunity and it belongs to you.
Why should you listen to him? It's your time to meet Jesus. Satan is using that sin to stop you. But fight on until you meet your Savior. Things are changing fast and this opportunity will not be there forever. Take this advantage now; your time is running out.

Bartimaeus refused to carry the responsibility of that fault and continued to call on Jesus even more; "***Son of David, have mercy on me!***" He did not pay any attention to them.
Jesus knew what was happening. He stood still and commanded him to be called. (Mark 10:49).
Jesus talked to him (according to verse 51).
So Jesus answered and said to him, "What do you want Me to do for you?" The blind man said to Him, "Rabboni, that I may receive my sight."

Mark 10:51 NKJV

A WANT VERSUS A NEED.

"What do you want me to do for you"*?*

Jesus had great knowledge and it was quite clear to all that the man was blind. *But he asks him what he wants to do for him.*
This was necessary because a person can have two choices:
a *want* and a *need.* In the case of this man, the answer was the same. His need was sight and what he wanted from Jesus was sight too. But in other cases, people can misplace them.

Peter and John.

Now Peter and John went up together into the temple at the hour of prayer, being the ninth hour. And a certain man lame from his mother's womb was carried, whom they laid daily at the gate of the temple which is called Beautiful, to ask alms of them that entered into the temple; Who seeing Peter and John about to go into the temple asked an alms. And Peter, fastening his eyes upon him with John, said, Look on us. And he gave heed unto them, expecting to receive something of them. Then Peter said, Silver and gold have I none; but such as I have give I thee: In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth rise up and walk. And he took him by the right hand, and lifted him up: and immediately his feet and ankle bones received strength.

Acts 3:1-7 KJV

Some people are missing great opportunities in their prayer points or petitions. Sometimes, we do not really arrange things or petitions well. Our needs and wants are misplaced or scattered. It is not surprising that the Lord Jesus revealed something great by saying:
"But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things shall be added to you.
Matthew 6:33 NKJV

We need the kingdom of GOD first and all will be added. I am not sure if we really seek, even in our prayers, the things of the Kingdom of GOD first. But "**all these**" first then the things of the kingdom.
It's like a young lady who is high tempered and a young man who fights frequently. Both of them want to go into marriage. One is short- tempered and the other likes fighting. They all want to go into marriage but the young lady is short- tempered and the young man is violent. It's like petrol and fire going into marriage. The communion will just need a matchstick to blow up everything even a poorly cooked food.
Their *need* is to get delivered from these weaknesses first; not marriage first. *They could first seek salvation which is their greatest need.*
After they have dealt away with these weaknesses then a *want* or marriage should come in. If the marriage they *want* comes in first before the salvation and deliverance they *need*,

that marriage can end up with life imprisonment. *You should be wise and avoid such direction or journey.* Marriage is ordained by *GOD* and intended for a blessing not a curse. Some women are not facing delays in their marital pursuit. But they are facing delays to know and work out on their *needs* before marriage. Others went into marriage without this wisdom and the marriage did not take long; the man is in prison. Put your house in a good order before your beautiful and great marriage. GOD wishes you the best in life. He loves you.
Here, Jesus gives Bartimaeus a choice and what he *wanted* from him and his *need* coincided. According to his words, he *wanted to see* and that was his *need* too. That was great. A *need and a want* coincided and he received the same.

So Jesus answered and said to him, "What do you want Me to do for you?" The blind man said to Him, "Rabboni, that I may receive my sight."
Mark 10:51 NKJV

Bartimaeus answers the Lord Jesus:
Rabboni, that I may receive my sight."
But my main point, in this part, is how this great and one- time opportunity could have been missed or lost. This could have been caused by other people, who were not Jesus. If he paid attention to them, he could have died still blind. On the other hand, they had never experienced the pain of blindness and the humiliation of begging in Jericho.

Why should you lose your marriage or family and cause your children to suffer by the advice of a person who has nothing to do with marriage? To make things worse, her counsel is not from the Lord. "*Mercy, just leave him, there are a lot of men out there."*
Yes, there are a lot of men out there but the two shall become one flesh. *This man is Mercy's one flesh or Mercy's one flesh is this man in discussion. GOD can change the worst person on Earth. He changed Saul of Tarsus. He can also change you or your husband and your son.*

[11] So the Lord said to him, "Arise and go to the street called Straight, and inquire at the house of Judas for one called Saul of Tarsus, for behold, he is praying. [12] "And in a vision he has seen a man named Ananias coming in and putting his hand on him, so that he might receive his sight." [13] Then Ananias answered, "Lord, I have heard from many about this man, how much harm he has done to Your saints in Jerusalem. [14] "And here he has authority from the chief priests to bind all who call on Your name." [15] But the Lord said to him, "Go, for he is a chosen vessel of Mine to bear My name before Gentiles, kings, and the children of Israel.
Acts 9:11-15 NKJV

Is your husband worse than Saul of Tarsus? Is your wife worse than that woman caught in the case of adultery in ***John 8****?*

[10] When Jesus had raised Himself up and saw no one but the woman, He said to her, "Woman, where are those accusers of yours? Has no one condemned you?" [11] She said, "No one, Lord." And Jesus said to her, "Neither do I condemn you;

go and sin no more." [12] Then Jesus spoke to them again, saying, "I am the light of the world. He who follows Me shall not walk in darkness, but have the light of life."
John 8:10-12 NKJV

Some marriages or families are scattered in the world not because the couple are the worst on Earth.
They are scattered because of wrong counsel, lack of love and prayer.
You should accept the council which is from or influenced by the Lord. It will not give you and your children some wounds tomorrow.

The issue is so small and simple. You should just humble yourself and pray; continue to love your family in order to preserve your children. Why should you listen to people who have nothing to do with family?
People who have nothing to do with prayer should not stop or discourage you from being a prayer warrior.
I have heard other people blaming people who are dedicated to prayer. They accuse them because they tend to spend more time in prayer than work or business. I would like to answer in this way.
The Bible discourages laziness to the extent of saying that those who will not work should not eat. That's enforcing hard work.

For even when we were with you, we commanded you this: If anyone will not work, neither shall he eat.

2 Thessalonians 3:10 NKJV

So people who pray a lot are not lazy. They may be working with you at the same institution. But on a working day, you can go to work having breakfast and you will have lunch but they may be fasting. At the same time, they are doing the same work with you but without any excuse or complaint. On top of that, they may be covering you and your families with their prayers. You may knock off from work and relax in your living room but they will go into their room doing intercession. At night, you will be sleeping but they will find time to be awake and pray for you and your nation. Over the weekend, you may be resting and watching television but they will go for a prayer meeting with fasting. They will be praying for the elections in your country. But they will not take a holiday for that; they will still be doing office work the same as you do. Are such people lazy? Aren't they a covering to you and your nation? Aren't they a brother's keeper?
I have a friend; he has a PhD and a former Principal of a private university. He was a running mate to a presidential candidate of another party. By last year, he had written seven books and was working to launch them. He sent me an invitation to that launch although I had some commitments then.
One time, I called him but he told me that he was away for intercession. He is a prayer warrior but a holder of a PhD.

People who are prayer warriors are not lazy. They are hard working. The Bible discourages laziness. Do not let people who have not passed through what you are passing through stop or discourage you from praying.
Bartimaeus did not allow them to stop him and he received his great miracle; he received his sight.
As far as counsel is necessary but not every counsel is good. You first go to the Lord and present your petition. If there will be a need for a sound counsel through a particular person, let the Lord direct you to that person. If the right counsel has been brought up or delivered, you will have peace of mind. On the other hand, a Godly counsel cannot go contrary to the Scriptures. Let the Lord lead otherwise, the world will be suffering with wounds of wars because of wrong counsel. I believe army generals and commanders are listening?
Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, refused to listen to those who tried to stop him.
This came from other people, not Jesus of Nazareth. It came at the wrong time. *His time to see the glory of GOD had come.* What did they want to achieve by answering first before the Master himself? You should be careful, wise and strong. Do not let the people who have not experienced what you are passing through (or anyone else) hinder you from knowing and meeting Jesus. Your greatest breakthrough, healing, blessings and salvation are all with him. Witches stole your marriage and your wealth *but your hope is not lost. Jesus has your answer.* He has that power to force your enemy to restore to you sevenfold.

[7] Lift up your heads, O you gates! And be lifted up, you everlasting doors! And the King of glory shall come in. [8] Who is this King of glory? The LORD strong and mighty, The LORD mighty in battle. [9] Lift up your heads, O you gates! Lift up, you everlasting doors! And the King of glory shall come in. [10] Who is this King of glory? The LORD of hosts, He is the King of glory. Selah

Psalm 24:7-10 NKJV

44] And he who had died came out bound hand and foot with grave clothes, and his face was wrapped with a cloth. Jesus said to them, "Loose him, and let him go."

John 11:44 NKJV

[51] Then, behold, the veil of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom; and the earth quaked, and the rocks were split, [52] and the graves were opened; and many bodies of the saints who had fallen asleep were raised; [53] and coming out of the graves after His resurrection, they went into the holy city and appeared to many. [54] So when the centurion and those with him, who were guarding Jesus, saw the earthquake and the things that had happened, they feared greatly, saying, "Truly this was the Son of God!" [55] And many women who followed Jesus from Galilee, ministering to Him, were there looking on from afar, [56] among whom were Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James and Joses, and the mother of Zebedee's sons.

Matthew 27:51-56 NKJV

Jesus is more powerful than all your enemies put together. All the power in Heaven and on Earth has been given to him. Your blessings and glory are with him. Therefore, do not allow anyone to stop you from meeting him.
He is the Alpha and the Omega.

"I am the Alpha and the Omega, the Beginning and the End, the First and the Last."
Revelation 22:13 NKJV

The more they stop you; the more you should seek to meet him. Everyone will go into his or her own coffin and grave except for a mass grave. But there are some who will not test that coffin and grave; they will not test death. They will be taken to Heaven alive and *congratulations to them.*
No one will enter with you into your coffin or grave as a token of love. *But Jesus gave that token of love by dying on the cross for you and me.* So do not let anyone hinder you from meeting him. The one hindering you did not die on the cross for you. He has no salvation. He cannot give you what Jesus has for you. So be wise and strong. *Jesus loves you than anyone else.*
[***46] Now they came to Jericho. As He went out of Jericho with His disciples and a great multitude, blind Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, sat by the road begging. [47] And when he heard that it was Jesus of Nazareth, he began to cry out and say, "Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me!" [48] Then many warned him to be quiet; but he cried out all the more, "Son of David, have mercy on me!" [49] So Jesus stood still and commanded him to be called. Then they called the blind man, saying to him, "Be of good cheer. Rise, He is calling you."***
Mark 10:46-49 (NKJV)

Then many warned him to be quiet; but he cried out all the more, "Son of David, have mercy on me!"

Again, do not let anyone or anything stop you from meeting Jesus and receiving your salvation and healing.
According to Ecclesiastes, ***there is a season, a time for every purpose.***
Do not miss your salvation and healing.
That was the right time for Bartimaeus and this is the right time for you.

The Story Of Bartimaeus- The Son Of Timaeus.

YOUR HOPE IS NOT LOST.

VII. LIFE LESSONS- PART VII.

YOUR FAITH HAS MADE YOU WELL.

I have discovered that the healing of Bartimaeus is the issue of his faith towards Jesus of Nazareth.

[***52] Then Jesus said to him, "Go your way; your faith has made you well." And immediately he received his sight and followed Jesus on the road.***
Mark 10:52 NKJV

I believe that there were many people in Jericho who had other issues and needed Jesus to address them. They might have sight unlike Bartimaeus but they had other needs too. They needed other miracles as well.
*Above all, there were some who needed this great salvation. They were right there in Jeri*cho. Have you thought it in that way?
Although Mark puts his attention on Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus but it's likely that there were others who needed other miracles but did not get them.
They had that great opportunity to meet Jesus and get their miracles but missed them.
One of the main factors has to do with their faith.
"Go your way; your faith has made you well."
Jesus does not say that his authority and power have made him well. He says that the faith of Bartimaeus has made him well.
When we listen carefully to this fact, we can easily establish that, this great miracle was done through his faith.
The power worked through the faith of Bartimaeus.
Authority and power can be there, even as they are available now but lack of faith can hinder a miracle. People think that the power of GOD is not as steady and practical in our time as it was during the time of the Lord Jesus. That is not true. Jesus is the same yesterday, today and forever. In fact, we have been promised greater works than what he did. The Enemy is fighting to weaken the faith of people or some believers. The promise, the authority and the power still stand and waiting for people of faith. They are still firm

but the faith is weakened. As a result, the miracle is not released. *The issue is to do with our faith.*

“ Go your way; your faith has made you well.”

That is why the Lord Jesus Christ asked the following question at the end of the following parable:

Then He spoke a parable to them, that men always ought to pray and not lose heart, saying: “There was in a certain city a judge who did not fear God nor regard man. “Now there was a widow in that city; and she came to him, saying, ‘Get justice for me from my adversary.’ “And he would not for a while; but afterward he said within himself, ‘Though I do not fear God nor regard man, ‘yet because this widow troubles me I will avenge her, lest by her continual coming she weary me.’ ” Then the Lord said, “Hear what the unjust judge said. “And shall God not avenge His own elect who cry out day and night to Him, though He bears long with them? “I tell you that He will avenge them speedily. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will He really find faith on the earth?”

Luke 18:1-8 NKJV

If people have grown faint in prayer and on the other hand, their faith is weakened, the end result is prayer without faith. In other words, it results into a *weak prayer.* A prayer which cannot bring the expected results; will not bring your answers or that miracle. It is the battle of faith and when we have lost that battle, the great miracle is lost too.
Bartimaeus won that battle of faith and got his great miracle. He got his sight.

“ Go your way; your faith has made you well.”

Faith makes miracles happen.
Christians should wake up and stay alert to the battle of their faith. The Enemy has spilled a great deal of doubts into the minds of many people. He has done this deliberately. He fights to weaken our faith and delay or try to stop the greater mighty works as we were promised.
He intends to stop your healing or miracle.
Your faith and mine have all entered into a battlefield. You can easily know whose faith has won on this battleground. Another faith is even on the frontline. *Let’s pray for that particular faith to stand no matter that wound and the blood that is flowing.* Do not be afraid; be strong and keep fighting for your victory. You are more than a conqueror through Jesus Christ.
“ Go your way; your faith has made you well.”
When some people tried to stop him from calling on the Lord, it means that they were stopping and weakening his faith.
We only hear about people stopping him but we do not know who was behind them in the spirit.

But the more they stopped him; the more he shouted. He kept calling on the Lord Jesus. This shows that he had strong faith. His faith could not be stopped or weakened.
The faith that could not be stopped or weakened until he received his sight. That is how you and me should live. There are many things fighting our faith. Bartimaeus is one of the best faith universities in modern days and majoring in overcoming hindrances to our faith. We can learn something great about faith from this spiritual school. Everyone wants a breakthrough or something good. It is beautiful to have good things to enjoy as provided by GOD. But we cannot please GOD without faith. We cannot get a miracle without faith. That miracle will either be hindered, delayed or stopped. Do not lose your faith and hope. You should keep on trusting GOD for your miracle is through your faith.

" Go your way; your faith has made you well."

I believe that opening the eyes of a Bartimaeus, *by his faith,* should be more difficult than having faith in the Lord Jesus to complete your project. You have struggled for some years to get it completed; to get your PhD, to get that position, to have that ministry reach out to the world. At this point, you want to give up. This is what you should know. *Your faith is in the battlefield. It can prevail or get defeated. It all depends upon you because it's your own faith. That of Bartimaeus also passed through a battlefield. His faith was not spared and he won the battle. That battle of faith. Your faith too, will not be spared and like Bartimaeus, you can win. You can get your long- awaited miracle.*

But due to the current circumstances, you no longer believe that success is possible. But the Good News is that from today, look to Jesus Christ the Author and Finisher of our faith. Trust his word and act upon it through your faith. You should pray or call on him like Bartimaeus and not letting the surrounding circumstances close your mouth or weaken your faith. That project, that course and the other needs will be realized or provided.
Your faith is in the battlefield. You don't have to give up but fight this battle of faith.

Again, the Enemy wants you to believe that success is no longer possible. But I want to assure you that, as Jesus is still alive, success is still possible and your hope is not lost.

Jesus asked:

Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will He really find faith on the earth?"

He did not question about cars, mansions, marriages or families. He did not ask about silver and gold, political parties or the wealth of modern times but he pointed out to faith.

Finally, the Book of Revelation comes up with an important verse to relate to this point. It says:

"***Because you have kept My command to persevere, I also will keep you from the hour of trial which shall come upon the whole world, to test those who dwell on the earth.***
Revelation 3:10 NKJV

The hour of trial...to test those who dwell on the Earth. Our faith is being tested in one way or the other. We will have to make a bold choice whether to trust the Word of GOD or the world; whether to trust the truth of the Bible or the lies of the Enemy. We have to make a bold choice whether to trust the teachings of Jesus Christ or the false religions and false doctrines.
The hour of trial is supposed to come on Earth. It's for you and me but we can position ourselves well and prevail.

The Lord Jesus is asking:

Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will He really find faith on the earth?"

It is the battle to do with our faith in order to stop this great salvation and that miracle. Do not lose your faith. This is not the time to lose faith but to trust GOD for healing and victory. The son of Timaeus could not be stopped. His faith was not weakened and he received his great miracle. *He received his sight.*
You can try the walk or the way of faith in Jesus Christ today. All the blessings of GOD to humanity have been placed or deposited in Jesus Christ. The sight of the son of Timaeus was in and through him. Your miracle too, is in *Jesus of Nazareth.* What makes us different from that blind man of Jericho is faith. What is hindering and delaying the miracle is the issue or the battle of faith. Our faith in the Word of GOD- *even in Jesus Christ.*
After reading this book, put your faith in a good order, start trusting GOD strongly. Do not allow anyone or anything weaken your faith. Your breakthrough is just ahead of you.
GOD loves you.

"Go your way; your faith has made you well."

May GOD bless you exceedingly.
You should remember that Jesus is alive and your hope is not lost.
THE STORY OF BARTIMAEUS- THE SON OF TIMAEUS.

VIII. LIFE LESSONS - PART VIII.

HE FOLLOWS JESUS ON THE ROAD.

[***52] Then Jesus said to him, "Go your way; your faith has made you well." And immediately he received his sight and followed Jesus on the road.***
Mark 10:52 NKJV

Bartimaeus had lived with blindness for years. He had mastered Jesus as shown through the titles he used to address him. This particular day seemed ordinary in the physical but it was a special day to the son of Timaeus. It was a special gift to him. He started that day still, a blind man but ended it with clear sight. It was a great miracle.
Although some people tried to stop him, instead of assisting him, *the man finally met the Master and received his sight.*
It was a great day; a day of healing, hope and restoration.
He was led to a place of begging in humiliation but today, he has met the Savior of the world and the greatest healer. He has been delivered from that humiliation; he is a free man. He can now find something to bring income to his family. A garment of shame is taken away and another one of praise has now come over his spirit and soul. He can now get a glorious- physical garment of his own choice. Things have changed within a short period of time.
***…Old things have passed away; behold, all things have become new*.** 2 Cor. 5:17(NKJV)
It's a new dawn, a new personality and a new world with new friends. He has passed through a new experience; he has met the *Messiah*.
The Scriptures have become real:

"***Therefore if the Son makes you free, you shall be free indeed.***
John 8:36 NKJV

Reader, isn't that awesome? This is how life was supposed to be. It was supposed to be from sickness to healing, from shame to glory, from failure to victory, from demonic bondage and oppression to spiritual and physical freedom. It was supposed to be from sin to holiness, from death to life and from a highway towards Hell to the only way to Heaven. That Way is Jesus.
Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, has found him and he is completely free today. *Will you be free today?* The answer remains with you reader.

THE LIFE LESSON IN THIS PART.

He Follows The Lord Jesus On The Road.

What Bartimaeus does here and worth learning is that he has changed the priority of life. First, it was family and money as many of us do today.
After this miracle, *after the love and mercy that Jesus has shown him*, he changes priority. He has changed to: '*GOD first.*'
I do not hear the Lord giving him instructions as with some of those who had received a miracle or GOD'S mercy. He is quiet and continues on his way; he does not stop him.

THE MAN POSSESSED BY LEGION.

So those who fed the swine fled, and they told it in the city and in the country. And they went out to see what it was that had happened. Then they came to Jesus, and saw the one who had been demon-possessed and had the legion, sitting and clothed and in his right mind. And they were afraid. And those who saw it told them how it happened to him who had been demon-possessed, and about the swine. Then they began to plead with Him to depart from their region. And when He got into the boat, he who had been demon-possessed begged Him that he might be with Him. However, Jesus did not permit him, but said to him, "Go home to your friends, and tell them what great things the Lord has done for you, and how He has had compassion on you." And he departed and began to proclaim in Decapolis all that Jesus had done for him; and all marveled.

Mark 5:14-20 NKJV

Bartimaeus follows the Lord on the road and the Lord does not stop him. He made the right choice in this case.

THE DEAF MAN AND IMPEDIMENT IN SPEECH.

Again, departing from the region of Tyre and Sidon, He came through the midst of the region of Decapolis to the Sea of Galilee. Then they brought to Him one who was deaf and had an impediment in his speech, and they begged Him to put His hand on him. And He took him aside from the multitude, and put His fingers in his ears, and He spat and touched his tongue. Then, looking up to heaven, He sighed, and said to him, "Ephphatha," that is, "Be opened." Immediately his ears were opened, and the impediment of his tongue was loosed, and he spoke plainly. Then He commanded them that they should tell no one; but the more He commanded them, the more widely they proclaimed it. And they were astonished beyond measure, saying, "He has done all things well. He makes both the deaf to hear and the mute to speak."

Mark 7:31-37 NKJV

Bartimaeus follows the Lord on the road and the Lord does not stop him. He made the right choice in this case.

A MAN WITH LEPROSY.

And it happened when He was in a certain city, that behold, a man who was full of leprosy saw Jesus; and he fell on his face and implored Him, saying, "Lord, if You are willing, You can make me clean." Then He put out His hand and touched him, saying, "I am willing; be cleansed." Immediately the leprosy left him. And He charged him to tell no one, "But go and show yourself to the priest, and make an offering for your cleansing, as a testimony to them, just as Moses commanded."

Luke 5:12-14 NKJV

Bartimaeus follows the Lord on the road and the Lord does not stop him. He made the right choice in this case.

THE TEN LEPERS.

Then as He entered a certain village, there met Him ten men who were lepers, who stood afar off. And they lifted up their voices and said, "Jesus, Master, have mercy on us!" So when He saw them, He said to them, "Go, show yourselves to the priests." And so it was that as they went, they were cleansed. And one of them, when he saw that he was healed, returned, and with a loud voice glorified God, and fell down on his face at His feet, giving Him thanks. And he was a Samaritan. So Jesus answered and said, "Were there not ten cleansed? But where are the nine? "Were there not any found who returned to give glory to God except this foreigner?" And He said to him, "Arise, go your way. Your faith has made you well."

Luke 17:12-19 NKJV

Bartimaeus follows the Lord on the road and the Lord does not stop him. He made the right choice in this case.

THE MAN WHO WAS SICK FOR THIRTY EIGHT YEARS.

Now a certain man was there who had an infirmity thirty-eight years. When Jesus saw him lying there, and knew that he already had been in that condition a long time, He said to him, "Do you want to be made well?" The sick man answered Him, "Sir, I have no man to put me into the pool when the water is stirred up; but while I am coming, another steps down before me." Jesus said to him, "Rise, take up your bed and walk." And immediately the man was made well, took up his bed, and walked. And that day was the Sabbath. The Jews therefore said to him who was cured, "It is the Sabbath; it is not lawful for you to carry your bed." He answered them, "He who made me well said to me, 'Take up your bed and walk.' " Then they asked him, "Who is the Man who said to you, 'Take up your bed and walk'?" But the one who was healed did not know who it was, for Jesus had withdrawn, a multitude being in that place. Afterward Jesus found him in the temple, and said to him, "See, you have been made well. Sin no more, lest a worse thing come upon you." The man departed and told the Jews that it was Jesus who had made him well.

John 5:5-15 NKJV

Bartimaeus follows the Lord on the road and the Lord does not stop him. He made the right choice in this case.

THE WOMAN CAUGHT IN THE CASE OF ADULTERY.

When Jesus had raised Himself up and saw no one but the woman, He said to her, "Woman, where are those accusers of yours? Has no one condemned you?" She said, "No one, Lord." And Jesus said to her, "Neither do I condemn you; go and sin no more." Then Jesus spoke to them again, saying, "I am the light of the world. He who follows Me shall not walk in darkness, but have the light of life."

John 8:10-12 NKJV

Bartimaeus follows the Lord on the road and the Lord does not stop him. He made the right choice in this case.

THE DAUGHTER OF JAIRUS.

When He came into the house, He permitted no one to go in except Peter, James, and John, and the father and mother of the girl. Now all wept and mourned for her; but He said, "Do not weep; she is not dead, but sleeping." And they ridiculed Him, knowing that she was dead. But He put them all outside, took her by the hand and called, saying, "Little girl, arise." Then her spirit returned, and she arose immediately. And He commanded that she be given something to eat. And her parents were astonished, but He charged them to tell no one what had happened.

Luke 8:51-56 NKJV

Bartimaeus follows the Lord on the road and the Lord does not stop him. He made the right choice in this case.

I will choose one case out of the above miracles of healings and resurrection. *I will focus on the case of leprosy with reference to the ten lepers.*
So leprosy is a stubborn disease. The procedure that was laid down for its examination and healing was not easy. This shows that it was not an ordinary disease.
The ten lepers asked for healing. Out of them, one came back to Jesus but the nine never came back to acknowledge him.

And one of them, when he saw that he was healed, returned, and with a loud voice glorified God, and fell down on his face at His feet, giving Him thanks. And he was a Samaritan. So Jesus answered and said, "Were there not ten cleansed? But where are the nine? "Were there not any found who returned to give glory to God except this foreigner?"

Bartimaeus follows the Lord on the road and the Lord does not stop him. He made the right choice in this case.

So the case of leprosy had a special procedure for examination and treatment. If someone received healing in a special way called a miracle, *from the Lord,* he was supposed to acknowledge him. All the ten lepers were supposed to glorify GOD through Jesus. But

this was either forgotten or neglected by the nine. One man, a Samaritan, came back to glorify the Lord.

Before I go further, let's look at some of the procedures for treating leprosy.

1. *Inspection by the Priest.*
2. *Isolation from the community.*
3. *Healing.*

After being examined outside the camp and a case of leprosy verified, two live- clean birds were taken together with cedar wood, scarlet wool and hyssop.
One bird gets slaughtered over fresh water, in a clay vessel. The live bird, hyssop, scarlet wool and cedar wood are dipped into the blood and water mixture. The person healed is sprinkled seven times; the live bird is set free. The concerned person washes his clothes and shaves the hair. He takes a bath and re- enters the camp but will remain outside his tent for seven days.
On the seventh day, he shaves again and washes. On the eighth day, offerings are made:
Sin offering.
Burnt offering.
Guilt offering.

4. *The priest takes some of the blood and oil; place them on the person's right earlobe, thumb and the big toe.*

Lev 13: 1- 46
Lev 14: 1- 32

Leprosy was considered as a physical manifestation of some wrong doing spiritually.
It is a stubborn disease with a complex procedure laid down to examine and treat it. But Jesus simplified it all with supernatural healing.
I believe it was worth acknowledging him, like that Samaritan. But the nine lepers never returned.

BARTIMAEUS FOLLOWS JESUS ON THE ROAD.

We have to acknowledge those who have contributed something to our well-being and above all, the Creator of the Heavens and the Earth. Think about the life we have, the sunshine, the moon and the stars. The breath, the water, oil, animals, birds and the fish. The fields that we have and the harvests we get from them. All the trees and fruits; gold and silver but also, other minerals...the list goes on. Don't you see that we need to acknowledge and thank GOD for all these? *We have to come back to Him*. We have to glorify and submit to Him.
On the other hand, think about a friend who sacrificed a lot and assisted you to get where you are today. Think about that man who picked you on your way to hospital. If that

journey was delayed, even by thirty minutes, you couldn't be reading this book today. What about your uncle who paid your tuition? Above that, he gave you extra assistance and you have become a cabinet minister. Where is his children? Have they ever set foot into your home? Think about them. What about your sister or that step sister who took the responsibility when you were suffering. You should remember how she cared for you like a mother. Where is she? Where is her children?

This list can go on but I will cut it short that you can add on those along your journey in this life. I am sorry to say that some of them are your pastors and their ministries. They have been forgotten and treated like dead people (*no physical communication*) and their ministries are like a graveyard(*only remembered and visited when in tears of death, a memorial and special functions*). Some will be remembered only when you are dead and they are called to conduct your funeral ceremony. The old church choir at home needs an electronic keyboard or a synthesizer and seeking to do some piecework in order to raise money. But you grew up in that congregation. The same choir will be called to sing all the night and day. It will decorate your departure from Earth. You can decorate them today.
But they are lost in the shuffle. Your village is like a graveyard too. It has turned out to be your enemy. *Are you afraid of spiritual enemies?* But you can send them food because they are suffering. It was in that village that you grew up. You were meant to be their ambassador whether they are friendly or wicked. Let God be the judge but you should remember to do good to them. Some boys and girls need assistance in their education. Again, you were meant to be their ambassador. GOD has blessed you to bless them.

But where are the nine?

What about that great Man who died on that Old- Ragged Cross to save your soul? What about Jesus of Nazareth?

But where are the nine?

Are you like those nine or like this Samaritan?

Leprosy was a stubborn disease and the procedure for its examination and healing was not simple. The nine were supposed to come back and thank the Lord.
The Samaritan did not just come back to thank him but he worshipped him. He ***fell down on his face at His feet.*** *He did not worship him in vain but he was also made whole. He was made complete or it was well with his spirit, soul and body. He was made whole.*

What I Know About Leprosy.

I still remember about this stubborn disease. There were some cases of leprosy in different places when I was young. My area was an Anglican missionary field. They build a primary school, a college and a hospital. The hospital started as a clinic with one nurse to take care of the missionaries. By the time of my writing, it has grown to a community hospital under the Anglican Diocese of the Upper Shire.

The missionaries also build a water- vessel- engineering site led by Francis Bell. My great grandfather, the group village head, sold this piece of land to the Anglican missionaries. I got much knowledge about leprosy right from my home district.

But where are the nine?

Leprosy troubled some parts of my country including my home district. There was a missionary who was the Principal of the St. Michaels Teachers Training College- Peter Garland. He also worked as a priest and on the frontline of leprosy eradication program. He was also very active in the transport section. I still remember the white boat they owned.
It was written *LEPRA*- for Leprosy Relief Association and formerly, the British Empire's Leprosy Relief Association- BELRA. A UK- based international charity that played a great role in the diagnosis, treatment, and control of leprosy.

But where are the nine?

I knew Peter Garland more as a LEPRA worker and later as a priest in the Church of England and listened to his sermon while I was here in Blantyre. I knew him since I was young.
So they owned that boat written LEPRA.
It was travelling from my area to Fort Maguire, now known as Makanjira, for leprosy treatment and related activities. What I am sharing here is my personal experience with the cases of leprosy from my area and district.

But where are the nine?

Therefore, St. Martins Missionary hospital, with Rev Peter Garland, played an important role in leprosy treatment and eradication in my community but also, my country.

But where are the nine?

Leprosy is really stubborn and a troublesome disease. It destroys the human flesh. I saw those suffering especially, the elderly. I never saw children or the youth suffering from it and I do not know why. But I could see some patients having their fingers or toes cut slowly or deformed. Some struggled to walk due to leprosy.
After getting healed in a miraculous or supernatural way, *the nine were supposed to come back and thank the Lord.* I see the importance of the question:

But where are the nine?

Bartimaeus takes his healing, his deliverance, his sight and sees the steps of the Lord then follows those steps. He follows the one who healed his blindness.
He follows the Lord Jesus on the road.

[***52] Then Jesus said to him, "Go your way; your faith has made you well." And immediately he received his sight and followed Jesus on the road.***
Mark 10:52 NKJV

This is the life lesson of part v111.

The Story Of Bartimaeus- The Son Of Timaeus.

Bartimaeus follows the Lord. His first priority is the Lord; family, money and friends will follow. Thus exactly what we are supposed to do on Earth today.
GOD should come first then our families and money. If not careful, money will be found while the families are scattered. A woman will be living in her own place, the children with their aunts and the man also living alone in a rented apartment.
In other or extreme cases, the house they owned could be waiting for a court judgment or put on sale. The Devil has managed to scatter that family. It will only take the hand of GOD to restore it.

But where are the nine?

You did not arrange things in a good order. Money became a god and family was nothing but other people mattered more than your wife and children. Alcohol was above the family and death is hovering to take a family member. Pray that GOD will have mercy on you and restore your long life.
Husbands and wives should be careful to take care of their families.
You should take care of your children. Do not be a cause or source of their suffering. You will not let the innocent children suffer because of your priorities and choices. *When you were young, your parents did not disturb your peace and education*. But today, you are the source of fear, stress and instability to your own children. One time you will be accountable before GOD on how you treated each other and your children too. The clock is ticking towards that hour. This is the right time to put things in a good order or for reconciliation.
Life is precious, take care of it with a good priority. *It should be* '*GOD first.'*

The Story Of Bartimaeus- The Son Of Timaeus.

He gave priority to the Lord who delivered him from the pain of blindness and the humiliation of begging in Jericho. Who could do this apart from him?
He showed him mercy, power and healing packed in great love. He gave him a life-time deliverance from blindness and the shame of begging. He healed and set him free.

Bartimaeus found it important to give his first priority to Jesus.

Sometimes, we have abused the power, miracles and the grace of the Lord Jesus? At certain times, we take things for granted.
The sun rises and it sets as the Earth rotates. We breathe in and out as the air is available. We drink and use the water as it is there for us. We use our lives the way we want. As far as GOD gave this life, it belongs to us and not to Him. He has no control over our lives.

But He is the King of the universe. He created the world and takes care but also, sustains it.
The Bible says that:
..The earth is the LORD's, and all its fullness, The world and those who dwell therein.

Psalm 24:1 NKJV

[1] Thus says the LORD: "Heaven is My throne, And earth is My footstool. Where is the house that you will build Me? And where is the place of My rest? [2] For all those things My hand has made, And all those things exist," Says the LORD. "But on this one will I look: On him who is poor and of a contrite spirit, And who trembles at My word. [3] "He who kills a bull is as if he slays a man; He who sacrifices a lamb, as if he breaks a dog's neck; He who offers a grain offering, as if he offers swine's blood; He who burns incense, as if he blesses an idol. Just as they have chosen their own ways, And their soul delights in their abominations, [4] So will I choose their delusions, And bring their fears on them; Because, when I called, no one answered, When I spoke they did not hear; But they did evil before My eyes, And chose that in which I do not delight."

Isaiah 66:1-4 NKJV

We abuse and misuse grace as far as it is available. We do not care that Jesus Christ paid a great price on that Old- Ragged Cross. There is no other sacrifice that could convince GOD for the salvation of humanity apart from that of Jesus. We should not misuse this great grace. We have to be thankful by accepting it and acknowledging Him.

But where are the nine?

Bartimaeus does not take his healing for granted. He follows the one who has shown him this great light.

Have we received salvation? *Yes*. We don't care and we live with no difference from those not saved. We speak like them and get high tempered like them.
Have we received the gift of tongues? *Yes*. But we don't care to read the instructions of the tongues. We speak anyhow until strange tongues have been accommodated into the Church and innocent Christians have been injured. We take things for granted and we don't care.
Have we received the gifts to teach, preach or to evangelize? *Yes*. But we don't care to ask the Holy Spirit what to teach or preach. We don't care to ask Him where to preach. The spiritual gifts really belong to us and we don't care about the Giver.

But where are the nine?

As far as money is available and music equipment is there, the Holy Spirit has been put aside and the ministry is done but without an impact. We take things for granted and

abuse this grace. But we can make a good decision or choice and put things in a good order and priority. *It should be* '*GOD first.'*

The Story Of Bartimaeus- The Son Of Timaeus.

So, we have abused or misused grace and forgotten that Ananias with Sapphira, his wife, died during the time of grace and they were believers.

Bartimaeus, takes his healing, his deliverance, his sight and sees the steps of the Lord then follows those steps. He follows the one who healed his blindness.

This is what we ought to do after knowing the Lord; after getting blessed by him or after having this precious life.

Sometimes, churches may have huge sums of money but they will not use these resources to advance the Kingdom of GOD. The main purpose should be to reach out to the masses perishing out there. But, sometimes, we will not use this money to do evangelism.
We will not take our resources and take the street kids from the streets. We will not build schools and beautiful homes for them then ease their suffering. We will not pay fees for the orphans though they suffer and sleep on an empty stomach. But we accumulate this money in the name of the Lord. We now own the money accounts, the other resources and no longer under the control of the Lord. If we get these resources in the name of the Lord, like Bartimaeus, we should follow him on the road of taking masses from the highway to Hell and to Paradise. Let's help the needy and ease their suffering. We should fill that gap left by our governments. The Church should stand to ease the suffering of the people out there. It's time to follow the Lord Jesus on the road as Bartimaeus- the son of Timaeus. GOD has blessed us with salvation and material resources. It's our responsibility to follow the Lord Jesus on the road and do his work with these blessings. I am sure that three or four big denominations, in one city, can be able to take out all the street kids and the homeless then feed them but also, send others to school. We will not wait for governments to do this but the Church should fill the gap. On the other hand, preaching the Good News of the Kingdom of GOD.

[38] "how God anointed Jesus of Nazareth with the Holy Spirit and with power, who went about doing good and healing all who were oppressed by the devil, for God was with Him. [39] "And we are witnesses of all things which He did both in the land of the Jews and in Jerusalem, whom they killed by hanging on a tree. [40] "Him God raised up on the third day, and showed Him openly, [41] "not to all the people, but to witnesses chosen before by God, even to us who ate and drank with Him after He arose from the dead. [42] "And He commanded us to preach to the people, and to testify that it is He who was ordained by God to be Judge of the living and the dead*.*

Acts 10:38-42 NKJV

Jesus went about doing good and healing all who were oppressed by the devil.

On the issue of leprosy, I have written about the Anglican missionaries who came in my area in the 1890s. I have written about the infrastructure they brought into this area and other missionary work. These including fighting leprosy. But they started their mission in the late 19th Century.
What if that work continued at that rate to this day? I believe this world could have been a so beautiful place to live but through the Church. Unfortunately, we have waited on political governments instead of governments waiting and relying on the Church. If all the churches in the world were put together, what a great world government could we have? We talk much about the one- world government of the Antichrist when we already have a greater government than that one. What if this great government of churches spent much time preaching the Gospel with signs, miracles and wonders but also, meeting the other needs of people? This could be so great and the same as following the Lord Jesus on the road.
Jesus went about doing good and healing all who were oppressed by the devil.

Let's follow the steps of the Lord for we are the salt and light of the world.
In that way, many people could see the goodness of the Lord and live a blessed life. Let's follow the steps of the Lord Jesus and save this world. It's on the verge of sinking.
Bartimaeus followed ***Jesus on the road.***
He wanted to acknowledge the source of his blessing. It was a great and life- time miracle.

People should know that he was blind but now received sight through Jesus.
People should know that he was nothing without Jesus.
People should give all the glory to GOD.
Let's glorify GOD with every blessing and gift He has given us. Let the world know that He is the source of that gift and blessing. Therefore, all the glory should go to Him. We should glorify Him with the gift of life. It is so precious.

Some of the people reading this message were so poor when they were young. But along the way, a brother, uncle, a parent's friend, a friend's relative, a neighbor, a missionary, an organization picked them up and helped them get higher education. *By the time of reading this message, the GOD who used those people to bail them out is totally forgotten.*
They cannot take His instructions. They do not remember Him. Some of the people GOD used to bring them to their positions have been forgotten. Some are still alive but separated as though dead.
On the other hand, they cannot do the same work of mercy to people who are suffering. If they occupy the position of a head teacher, they can send away a needy student due to tuition. But a Good Samaritan once took care of them. *They have already forgotten GOD and that Good Samaritan. They have also abandoned that token of mercy shown to them.*
Had they remembered that mercy, they couldn't ill-treat that needy student.
Their wives have become enemies to their mothers. A mother- in- law versus a- daughter-in- law. It has turned out into a civil war. The main issue is money. This ought not to be so brethren. We are called to love one another and to be peacemakers.

Do you know that the greatest blessings and glory of Ruth were hidden in her mother-in-law? As poor as she looked but her latter blessings were hidden in her and more than in her own husband or relatives. Imagine if she despised that old woman; that mother- in-law? GOD can sometimes bless you through a mother- in - law. Be a blessing to her. *Make her your own mother. She is not an enemy but a partner in your glory, blessing and destiny.* Do not let money or the riches of this world divide you. These are temporary. They will not go to Heaven. There is greater life than the present one. Imagine Ruth and Naomi living together in Heaven; isn't that beautiful and glorious? Therefore, love and be reconciled to one another. GOD loves you.
This message now goes to mother- in- laws. Some of your daughter -in- laws may carry greater blessings for you than your own daughters. So be wise and live in peace and love with them. You should see them as your own daughters.

Let's think about the support and care that Ruth gave to Naomi. On the other hand, the advice that Naomi gave to Ruth. It was supposed to be in that way. That was great and how it is supposed to play between a daughter- in- law and mother-in- law.

[***52] Then Jesus said to him, "Go your way; your faith has made you well." And immediately he received his sight and followed Jesus on the road.***
Mark 10:52 NKJV

Bartimaeus, the son of Timaeus, received his sight immediately and followed the Lord Jesus on the road.
You should follow him today.

THE STORY OF BARTIMAEUS- THE SON OF BATIMAEUS.
YOUR HOPE IS NOT LOST.

YOU CAN LIVE AGAIN.

TODAY CAN BE THE DAY OF YOUR SALVATION.

In life, there is a day to be born and the day to die or taken into Heaven by means of the Rapture. In whatever way, we all wish to find a place of Eternal rest where we will no longer be in pain but live joyfully with the Lord and forever.
We all need salvation so that we can be free from the bondage of Satan and the bondages of this life then lead a peaceful and joyful life. That life which is beyond the material possessions of this world. *We all need that peace and joy which comes from the Lord Jesus.*
You will agree with me that money has its own peace and joy; likewise a car, a beautiful home and a good marriage too. A beautiful bicycle can also bring in joy but when its handlebar and the hub are broken and the chain cut into pieces, that joy and the peace of travel are all gone. They were temporary. They were based on the durability of that bicycle.

TODAY CAN BE THE DAY OF YOUR SALVATION.

You will realise that all these, apart from the Lord, have no eternal peace and joy. A storm or war can arise at any time and disrupt our possessions in this world. But the peace and joy that come from the Lord are not dependent upon material possessions nor those circumstances around us. They are sure as the fruit of the *Spirit of Christ.* They are not dependent upon money, possessions or material things. They are the fruits of the Holy Spirit. That is the peace and joy that the world needs today. There are many storms in this world which can instantly destroy the peace and joy that come from material possessions and related circumstances. That was why Jesus said that:
"***Peace I leave with you, My peace I give to you; not as the world gives do I give to you. Let not your heart be troubled, neither let it be afraid."***
John 14:27 (NKJV)
When Jesus Christ offers you a *salvation package*, he includes this peace and joy; not that which is based on material possessions or surrounding circumstances. This peace and joy come from him amidst the storms of this life. They will sustain us through our difficulties as we are waiting to go to Heaven. He offers these as part of GOD's *salvation package to humanity.* Material things and money are good when you are with the Lord. *On* their own, *they fall short of eternal peace and joy.* As material things are temporary, their peace and joy are also temporary and incomplete. True peace and Joy come as the fruits of the Holy Spirit - who is the Spirit of Christ. Therefore, real peace and joy come from the Lord Jesus. That is why he is called *the Prince Of Peace*. He promised to give us peace that the world (*money, material things plus governments*) cannot give. We all need this peace and we need the joy.

For unto us a Child is born, Unto us a Son is given; And the government will be upon His shoulder. And His name will be called Wonderful, Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace.
Isaiah 9:6 NKJV

"***Peace I leave with you, My peace I give to you; not as the world gives do I give to you. Let not your heart be troubled, neither let it be afraid.***
John 14:27 NKJV

for the kingdom of God is not eating and drinking, but righteousness and peace and joy in the Holy Spirit.
Romans 14:17 NKJV

TODAY CAN BE THE DAY OF YOUR SALVATION.
Gal 5 (NKJV)
[19] ***Now the works of the flesh are evident, which are: adultery, fornication, uncleanness, lewdness,*** [20] ***idolatry, sorcery, hatred, contentions, jealousies, outbursts of wrath, selfish ambitions, dissensions, heresies,*** [21] ***envy, murders, drunkenness, revelries, and the like; of which I tell you beforehand, just as I also told you in time past, that those who practice such things will not inherit the kingdom of God.*** [22] ***But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, longsuffering, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, 23 gentleness, self-control. Against such there is no law.*** [24] ***And those who are Christ's have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires.***
These are the fruits of the Holy Spirit that come to you when you *repent of all your sins and receive Jesus Christ as your Lord and Savior.*

and the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and minds through Christ Jesus.
Philippians 4:7 NKJV

Indeed, the peace of GOD which comes through Christ will surpass all understanding.
It is part of the gift of salvation and it's eternal- in this life and that to come. Isn't that beautiful and great. Even the UN and any non- governmental organization cannot give such peace. It's from GOD; found in and through Christ only. It's released through his Spirit as one of His fruits. We all need this peace amidst thes troubled waters of this sinking world.

TODAY CAN BE THE DAY OF YOUR SALVATION.

The Bible says:
John 3 (NKJV)
[16] For God so loved the world that He gave His only begotten Son, that whoever believes in Him should not perish but have everlasting life.
[17] For God did not send His Son into the world to condemn the world, but that the world through Him might be saved.

When the Bible says that: ***GOD SO LOVED THE WORLD*****,** you and me were included. We were (and some are still) in sin but instead of God sending judgement He sent salvation. It's not like that generation of Noah which was judged by water and the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah which were judged by fire.
This time, he has not done the same. Instead of such judgments, He sent His beloved Son to save you and me. Isn't that great love and grace? To me, GOD's grace means the maximum of His love and mercy put together and results into free salvation to the sinner.

Then sin no more or lead a holy life after this salvation. A life totally set apart to the will of GOD.

What remains is for you to humble yourself and come to Him with true repentance and receive your salvation.

TODAY CAN BE THE DAY OF YOUR SALVATION.

Let me finish by saying this and with reference to the Bible:

John 3 (NKJV)

1 There was a man of the Pharisees named Nicodemus, a ruler of the Jews. 2 This man came to Jesus by night and said to Him, "Rabbi, we know that You are a teacher come from God; for no one can do these signs that You do unless God is with him." 3 Jesus answered and said to him, "Most assuredly, I say to you, unless one is born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God." 4 Nicodemus said to Him, "How can a man be born when he is old? Can he enter a second time into his mother's womb and be born?" 5 Jesus answered, "Most assuredly, I say to you, unless one is born of water and the Spirit, he cannot enter the kingdom of God. 6 That which is born of the flesh is flesh, and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit. 7 Do not marvel that I said to you, 'You must be born again.'

We are born biologically but when we start a brand- new life in the Lord, by turning from sin and receiving Jesus Christ as our Lord and Savior, it becomes a spiritual birth. *You are born a brand-new person in the kingdom of GOD or spiritually.*

The murders, the adultery that you committed; the robbery, the fights, the cult that you were involved in, just to mention some, *are all forgiven. They are erased through the blood of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ. You have become a brand- new or a born-again* person.

This way of salvation is found no where in the world except in Jesus Christ. There is no religion that offers salvation in that way. *It is found in Jesus Christ only and it's called grace.* That is why there is no other religion that has a Savior in this world or that is why there is no other Savior in the world except Jesus Christ. You should surrender to him today.

Now you have become a good and fertile ground for the Holy Spirit and His *fruits* and gifts including *peace* and *joy*. That is how salvation works. So, these are part of the salvation package from the Lord Jesus.

TODAY CAN BE THE DAY OF YOUR SALVATION.

When a Pharisee and a teacher of the Law came to Jesus on the issues of salvation and wanted to know this **(vs 9, 10, 11**), we should not treat his questioning as a small issue.

John 3 :9 NKJV

9 Nicodemus answered and said to Him, "How can these things be?"
10 Jesus answered and said to him, "Are you the teacher of Israel, and do not know these things?
11 Most assuredly, I say to you, We speak what We know and testify what We have seen, and you do not receive Our witness.

The topic was quite big. He weighed himself and found that something greater was missing. So he went to Jesus to learn about the new life. Traditional Christians, Muslims, Rastafarians, world leaders and politicians; scientists, lecturers and billionaires were supposed to do this through his ministers. Nicodemus also represents the elite- those at the top of the world. They are at the top but may be at the bottom in the things of salvation or the things of the kingdom of God. They can miss the greater glory of the life to come but Jesus loves and died for them too. No one was left out in GOD's grace through Jesus Christ. He died for them too hence the example of Nicodemus.
We should come over to that point where we realise that we have billions of dollars, mansions, beautiful cars and homes, PhDs; we have medals in the military and many more but *we are missing something greater.* We should come over to this very point like Nicodemus. You will not wait until GOD Himself weighs you in His balance and be found wanting. Do not be found in the position like that of Belshazzar the king of Babylon.
Dan 5 (NKJV)

[24] Then the fingers of the hand were sent from Him, and this writing was written. [25] "And this is the inscription that was written: MENE, MENE, TEKEL, UPHARSIN. [26] This is the interpretation of each word. Mene: God has numbered your kingdom, and finished it; [27] Tekel: You have been weighed in the balances, and found wanting; [28] Peres: Your kingdom has been divided, and given to the Medes and Persians." [29] Then Belshazzar gave the command, and they clothed Daniel with purple and put a chain of gold around his neck, and made a proclamation concerning him that he should be the third ruler in the kingdom. [30] That very night Belshazzar, king of the Chaldeans, was slain. [31] And Darius the Mede received the kingdom, being about sixty-two years old.

That was dangerous- a result of not honoring *The Most High GOD*. We should think about that.
TODAY CAN BE THE DAY OF YOUR SALVATION.
Let Me Share This Night Vision:
I had a night vision and saw a prominent footballer from Africa on a football contract in another continent in the East. I saw him fall suddenly and die. The vision ended. But I had understanding why that happened to him.

If you ponder on this, you will see that this life is temporary. We will all leave this place to another. Sometimes, death is coming suddenly or instantly. On the other hand, Jesus is coming soon and we are caught up in the middle.
If we see Jesus as delaying but on the other hand, death is still coming fast and sometimes sudden. So we are still caught in the middle.
In this world, there is time to be born and time to die. One time we will leave this world and go to that destiny we built while on Earth; to be with the Lord Jesus or with the cruel master in Hell and later, the Lake of Fire. The choices we make today will determine our destiny tomorrow.
You can make a good choice today. You can repent your sins and receive Jesus Christ as your Lord and Savior then live with him in peace and joy forever.
TODAY CAN BE THE DAY OF YOUR SALVATION.

PRAYER.

Heavenly father, I humble myself before you. I repent all my sins and ask for your forgiveness. I open my heart and receive Jesus Christ as my Lord and Savior. I forgive every person who has offended me and ask you to write my name in the Book Of Life.
In The Name Of Jesus Christ, I Pray.

If you do not go to Church, find a Bible believing Church where they teach the true doctrine of Jesus Christ. You can find believers of the Lord Jesus Christ anywhere and join them for your spiritual growth.

For any questions or counselling, you can contact the author.

GOD LOVES YOU.
JESUS IS ALIVE AND YOUR HOPE IS NOT LOST.

By the grace of the Lord, you will get more in the other editions and the upcoming book:
The Great Story Of Boldness And Courage.

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I was born from a Muslim mother but my father was a Catholic and a government agent (CID), in Malawi. I grew up in the Church of England but later started a full-time ministry. My journey of writing Christian literature started wthin some circumstances which I described in the other upcoming book- THE GREAT STORY OF BOLDNESS AND COURAGE.

I Hope you will be encouraged after reading this book which is part of the series- FINDING JESUS TODAY.

You are going to enjoy it.

Thank you.

Enock Mbendera

